CAMPAIGNER GUIDE TO RELATIONSHIPS

Enhance romantic partnerships, friendships, and parent-child relationships

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Relationships Matter to Campaigners

Campaigners believe in the power of social connections to change the world, and only by cooperating with other people can they create outcomes that far outstrip those that any one person might accomplish on their own. Campaigners love nothing more than connecting with someone new, whether it's a business partner, a friendly acquaintance, or just a name on a screen. Ongoing personal conflict is their kryptonite, however, and they tend to go to great lengths to work though disagreements with others and restore harmony.

As friends, Campaigners can be witty, spontaneous, and loyal – almost to a fault. Their intense empathy makes them companions who listen and try to understand their chums. They care enough to be there when they're needed. Their Extraverted and Intuitive personality traits make them the perfect guides for exciting and memorable outings with friends.

Campaigners in love can be among the most romantic of all personality types. The trappings of romance aren't lost on their sensitive nature or their rich appreciation for the symbolic. While not always the most organized partners, Campaigners can make up the difference with the degree of love and compassion that they bring to their relationships.

When children come on the scene, Campaigners can almost match their energy and enthusiasm. The children of a Campaigner will likely never have to question their parent's love. The warmth and sense of wonder that Campaigners bring to a household are so genuine, they're almost childlike. Right and wrong are likely to be important topics at the dinner table.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Joyous Togetherness

While Campaigners may take different approaches to various kinds of relationships, one thing forms a common thread throughout their social attachments: they revel in sharing joy with others. If possible, Campaigners would inject some form of humor, excitement, or warmth into all of their social interactions. The only exception is when

serious moments call for empathy and compassion, and even then, Campaigners will do their utmost to elevate the feelings of others to whatever degree they can. While Campaigners are also known to stand with passion against what they see as wrong, they'd prefer to spread positivity.

When Campaigners connect with their own inner emotional buoyancy, it tends to make their relationships – of all types – easier and more fulfilling. Their mood and energy often take a central role in guiding the course of their personal interactions, swaying others to match Campaigners' vibe. When the joy that comes naturally to Campaigners creeps into the everyday moments that they share with others, in whatever context that may take place, it tends to create something meaningful. Even seemingly mundane, routine experiences like making a meal or tackling a household chore become treasured moments when two people share a joyful feeling. Part of the magic that Campaigners bring to their relationships is that lighthearted spark. It stems from how they're always seeking to explore the world around them and always staying open to the possibility of discovering something delightful. That mindset is a great way for Campaigners to create the most rewarding relationships possible.

Friendships

Though their dreams and ideas can be as lofty as the clouds, simple, genuine friendship is one of the most incredibly satisfying experiences for Campaigners. Sharing their energy with treasured friends gives these types a chance to express the core of their being, whether it's imagination or action. In a great friendship, they find delight in unexpected reflections of their own potential. Friends reinforce Campaigners' direction in life, and may open new and amazing possibilities.

Open Minds

Campaigners may be the most adaptive personality type when it comes to friendship. Their outgoing energy, matched with the open and curious Prospecting trait, helps them reach out to all manner of people.

Some of the positive ways Campaigners approach friendship include:

- **Accepting others.** These types may feel an easy camaraderie with other Campaigners and Diplomats, but they don't stop there. They are likely to enthusiastically embrace a wide range of people, including those who are different from themselves.
- **Socially exploring.** These types are often able to "speak the language" of other personality types when needed. Their curiosity often has them seeking out new friends who can introduce them to unfamiliar potentials.

- **Adapting.** Campaigners are flexible in their style of relating to their friends. These types can shift deftly from small talk to discussing grand ideas and find something of value in both.
- **Interacting brightly.** These types enjoy lively in-depth talks exploring exciting, high-flying concepts. However, they embrace simple fun and lighthearted casual conversations with equal joy.

With their open hearts and minds, Campaigners broadly welcome others into their lives unless given a reason not to. There are some preferred criteria by which Campaigners choose their close friends, however, and not all make it to their inner circle.

Seeking Deep Friendships

Giving their true friendship is an area where Campaigners are especially heartfelt. These types greatly value empathy, support, and authenticity. With their sense of idealism added to this combination, the depth of their friendships can become quite profound when they meet the right people.

Their pursuit of deep friendships has some key aspects:

- **Seeking hearts of gold.** Campaigners are good at reading people, naturally making distance between themselves and insincere individuals. Recognizing the feelings of others allows them to be very insightful and invest in the lives of those they feel a deeper connection with.
- **Finding mental compatibility.** Campaigners need a few good friends in their lives who understand their vision and can go with them deep into imagination. Not all personality types can sustain the dynamic flow of concepts, topics, and high-energy banter that comes with Campaigner friendships. But those than can are cherished by these types.

Appreciating certain qualities doesn't mean that Campaigners require all their friends to meet some lofty standard. But finding valued compatibilities can mean the difference between making a friend and embarking on a lifelong friendship.

Quality Time

Adventures of both the imagination and of the physical world attract these types – they are highly flexible and enthusiastic. Whether their comradeship is more "talk" or "walk" can depend on the friends involved, but active liveliness is almost certain. Experiences filled with warmth, connection, and exploration are likely to have Campaigners' full attention – at least for a time.

A day hanging out with Campaigners could include almost anything:

- **Mutual discovery.** Outgoing and active, they may base friendships on shared activity like hiking or cultural engagement. Campaigners appreciate experiences that include companionship, whether they meet that friend through the course of an activity or one of them introduces the other to it.
- **Going with the flow.** Campaigners can shift their attention without missing a beat, sitting in the corner of a club talking about their beliefs one minute, only to jump up and dance when the right song plays. And, as soon as the mood strikes them, they're ready to leave – inviting friends to join in the new direction.

Friends can rely on Campaigners' flexibility and grace to help them keep up with such potential pivots in interest. The fun and excitement can be well worth everyone involved working to stay in sync. But as open and congenial as these types are, there are no perfect relationships, and even Campaigners may have occasional moments of friction with their friends.

Potential Pitfalls for Campaigners and Their Friends

Every friendship comes with challenges, and though Campaigners try to maintain harmony, everybody has something to learn. Problems within these friendships usually occur when any party is too insistent on their own way of doing things, especially if that insistence turns into criticism.

Potential areas of trouble include:

- **Questionable paths.** Few are as willing to act on their imaginations as Campaigners, and their dreams and ideas can seem unrealistic to other types. Their friends might find it hard to watch these types embrace pursuits that seem risky or go nowhere. When

Campaigners indulge their passion for excitement, more sedate thinkers may find themselves perplexed and concerned.

- **Bold disregard.** Campaigners tend to be vigorously true to themselves, and they may ignore their friends' concerns in favor of their own vision of reality. In fact, they can be condescending or even argumentative to those who disagree. This can make friends feel devalued, and Campaigners might miss out on the balancing influence of outside perspectives.

Like all types, Campaigners may benefit from examining their output within a friendship. Luckily, their sincere desire to connect with others gives them an almost automatic desire to treat their friends well and adapt their behavior when necessary. Making friendships fun is a core drive for Campaigners, and compromise is a gift that says a friendship is valuable enough to make sacrifices for.

Campaigner Friends by Role

Making Friendships Work – With Anyone

With their adaptable energy and fertile imaginations, Campaigners can find mindful ways to give to their friends without diminishing their sense of authenticity. Their flexibility and awareness allow them to form and sustain good friendships with anyone they choose, regardless of personality type. The following sections examine how Campaigners and people from each Role tend to relate to each other, and offer some ideas for making these relationships shine even brighter.

Campaigner-Analyst Friendships

These friends tend to meet with their minds. They may have different values, priorities, and methods, but nonetheless catch each other's interest through a mutual spark of mental agility. While they may argue, it's often the inspired creative sparring of innovators blending their ideas and playing off each other.

If their friendship has a weakness, it's that their glee in exploring the realm of possibility together may consume them to distraction – or occasionally get out of hand. Despite this potential, these friends benefit from challenging each other to expand their thinking, and they often have fun in the process.

Balanced Campaigner-Analyst Friendships

Showing Each Other Truths from Different Angles

Campaigners and Analysts both share a fondness for abstract ideas, though they tend to see them through very different lenses. Campaigners love to rhapsodize about their hopes and visions, while Analysts try to understand and explain things with their unrelenting logic.

With their differing approaches and perspectives, these types can benefit deeply from their friendship in key ways:

- **Balancing principles.** Where Analysts often put a clinical and efficient spin on life, Campaigners love to infuse everything with heart and soul. Both approaches are grand principles that can make life better, and when these friends stay open to each other's ways they complement each other wonderfully.

- **Finding feasibility.** Campaigners have grand visions for their future. But they may have trouble deciding which path holds the most interest, or even finding a realistic direction. Analysts are all about examining things and finding ways to make them work better. They can help Campaigners connect their dreams to reality by offering a rational, detailed look at ideas.

- **Opening possibilities.** In turn, Campaigners can offer a connection to the less tangible, human side of things. Analysts often lose sight of softer fundamentals in their mental zeal. They don't as easily relate to the emotions of others, and this can leave them feeling disconnected on everything but an intellectual level. Through their example and counsel, Campaigners can help such friends find a better understanding of themselves and others. They happily open doors and accompany Analyst friends into the humanistic side of life.

When they respect and learn from each other, both types' approaches to life become more balanced. But friendship isn't all about deep matters of supportive development, and these two are likely to inspire each other when it comes to the lighter sides of life as well.

Witty Fun

Serious matters aside, Campaigners' and Analysts' differences also serve as vast and unending sources of enjoyment when these friends have fun together. Nearly any experience can be a playground for Campaigners and Analysts as they tease out different aspects of their subjects.

Likely areas of witty fun for these friends include:

- **Sparkling conversation.** These two types joyfully embrace their mutual interests, and neither can resist sharing what they think about every little thing. These friends' many views can turn a conversation about what movie to watch into an exploratory debate on human morality.

- **Walking new ground.** The excitement goes beyond talk when either of these friends delves into an activity loved by the other. Campaigners enjoy sharing something personal – such as music

or art – with their more cynical Analyst friends. In turn, Analysts delight in showing their adventurous Campaigner friends the inner workings of their beloved interests, whether it's a favorite game, book series, or a technical hobby.

- **Social swashbuckling.** These two can enjoy spreading their brand of cheerful wit among others. Campaigners make the perfect ambassadors to assist overly intellectual Analysts in expanding their social circle. Campaigners can make a simple night out into a scintillating, joyful experience, even for the more socially reticent. And Analysts, in turn, add lively, intellectual spice to any group.

Campaigners have diverse interests, and while these friends might not fully share each other's chosen passions, they marvel at discovering something fun and new. For Campaigner and Analyst pals, sharing active everyday experiences together can be just as enjoyable as cavorting in the realm of the theoretical. But even the brightest minds can have dark moments that trouble a friendship, if they let them.

Unbalanced Campaigner-Analyst Friendships

Cutting Communication

Starkly rational Analysts and dreamy, compassionate Campaigners can balance each other's traits, but they can also experience some clashes. Differences in communication styles are one of the things that can set this otherwise very compatible pair apart, even after they've formed a solid friendship.

Campaigner and Analyst friends may test each other's patience in these ways:

- **Cold, hard honesty.** Analysts tend to be blunt and they can come across as harsh, especially when they logically dissect other people's precious notions. For them, facts are straightforward and best taken that way, and they rarely sugarcoat their truths. Campaigners don't usually appreciate such raw rationality, and when they perceive meanness from friends – correctly or not – they're sharply disappointed.

- **Hot reactions.** Cutting words can go both ways. Expressive with their feelings, Campaigners can be easily irritated if they feel their Analyst friends lack understanding – and may angrily lash out at perceived cynicism. Analysts may be open to logic-based arguments, but they rarely respond well to subjective criticism, emotional rationales, or heated outbursts. In fact, emotionally charged moments can offend them.

These types are capable of getting past any differences, but their loftier qualities still depend on basic goodwill and maturity to flourish. When either of these types lets their criticism or reactions go too far in a simple human moment of upset, they can easily hurt each other's feelings.

Differences of the Heart

Campaigners crave heartfelt bonds with their friends. They enjoy having significant, unspoken connections that aren't as easy for Analysts to develop. Analysts' tendency to be less open to "softer" forms of connection can limit the experiences these friends share.

This difference can show up in more than one way:

- **Guarded hearts.** Campaigners can be perplexed when Analyst friends seem resistant to sharing feelings – and are awkwardly reluctant when such a need arises. Analysts often ignore troubling emotions to avoid feeling out of their depth. But any seeming lack of support, however unintentional, is likely to be hurtful and confusing for Campaigners.
- **Conceptual disconnection.** Things like art, alternative medicine, and spirituality may speak to Campaigners on a deep level, and they want their friends to hear that voice of beauty as well. But Analysts, for all their creative imagination, may simply not be as open to mystical interpretations of reality. When Campaigners want to tread wild paths, Analysts may not be willing to suspend their disbelief to join in more metaphysical journeys.

Campaigners are sure to feel disappointed at not being able to fully share experiences that are important to them with a good friend. In turn, Analysts can be bewildered by expectations that they cannot

comfortably meet, resenting being pushed into things that simply don't hold as deep a meaning for them. But both these types have the tools within to overcome any disharmony in their friendships.

Rebalancing Campaigner-Analyst Friendships

Learning to Listen Fairly

Intuitive types' mental flexibility equips them to address problems within their friendships. If they're willing to try to understand each other, these two types can learn to appreciate the distinct ways they express themselves.

Friendship should make people feel larger, not smaller. These friends must give each other room to be who they are, including their very different communication styles. Analysts often talk in blunt ways, and Campaigners like to connect warmly, but their different styles of interaction don't need to cause offense or interfere with honest communication.

The key for both these mentally active types is to focus on the *intent* of each other's words more than the style. When Analysts are dispassionate, Campaigners can look past the surface to find the real messages they're expressing. Analysts may seem cynical, but they're likely chasing insightful ideas that are important to them – and can ultimately make sense to Campaigners.

To help move past differences in communication styles, these friends can employ some helpful techniques:

- When a friend voices a view, listen carefully to the literal message they are expressing.
- Think about the meaning of their words without personal prejudices and assumptions. What do *they* mean by their words? Campaigners can draw on their empathy here to put themselves in their friend's shoes.
- Ask questions and give each other a chance to explain statements and opinions before reacting.

- If responding with criticism or disagreement, explain why in a respectful way.
- As a conversation progresses, show each other the respect of listening and responding without becoming testy.
- Try to be permissive of each other's styles of expression; there's room for differences in a friendship.
- Remember to base friendship on positives. There's no reason that conflicts can't simply be tossed aside in favor of fun – it's a choice both types can make.

Both Campaigners and Analysts tend to get carried away by their own imaginations, but when they take time to truly listen – and explore the thoughts that matter – to each other, their different ways of saying things don't seem to matter as much.

Investing in Analyst Friendship

Campaigners and their Analyst friends can adjust how they share their emotions by allowing for and clearly stating their needs and limits. Analysts might not always shine when Campaigners are seeking emotional connection, but they nonetheless make caring friends. Campaigners can put the emotional and mystical into solid terms without expecting Analysts to empathically know where they're coming from or respond in kind. Campaigners can also be clear when they're just seeking basic sympathy, as Analysts rarely pick up on such needs without prompting.

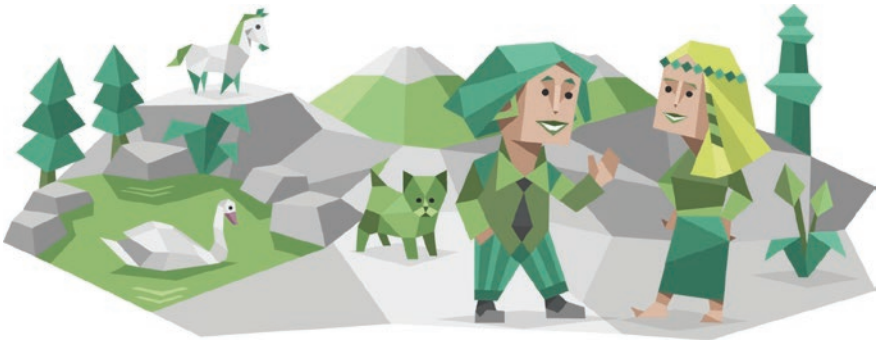
Campaigners may need to ask Analysts to give attention to the intangible aspects of their friendships, explaining why such things matter and how to do so. Analysts understand the value of putting effort in their friendships. Sincere attempts to be sympathetic, understanding, and open to abstract experiences goes a long way toward making Campaigners happy. Campaigners can also be respectful when Analysts approach their limits; time together doesn't always have to be profound.

Realistic balance requires that both these types clearly ask for yet not demand too much from each other. They can both use these steps:

- Communicate needs clearly. There's no shame in directly asking a friend for support, guidance, or company.
- Use plain language.
- Request dedicated time to talk together.
- Pick an environment both types of friends find comfortable – perhaps a stroll somewhere private or other light activity to ease any awkwardness.
- Talk honestly, and allow for personal limits.
- Listen respectfully.
- Specifically describe the point of thought, and ask for a response to it – "What do you think?"
- Give verbal support. It's OK to say, "I don't fully get where you're coming from, but I'm here for you."
- After sharing personal or emotional experiences, engage in some favorite down-to-earth pastimes together to balance the abstract and contemplative with some tangible fun.

Emotional hand-holding may not be Analysts' specialty, but recognizing logical priorities is. Good friendships are something they're happy to invest in. Campaigners, in turn, can take a moderate approach to emotional interactions with their Analyst friends, recognizing that it's not always fair to expect deep intimacy from their friendship.

Campaigner-Diplomat Friendships



For Campaigners, close friendship with fellow Diplomats can be a powerful bond, as these types tend to welcome compatible people sincerely into their hearts and lives. Their common approaches and temperament can transcend any differences. Diplomats exercise their imaginations and feelings extravagantly, enabling these friends to share far more than mere words together. Of course, when they do talk, they're unlikely to run out of things to say. As their friendships progress, they may even become so deep as to approach a feeling of family.

Balanced Campaigner-Diplomat Friendship

A Mental and Emotional Extension

Campaigners who befriend other Diplomats may have the wonderful experience of gaining a kind of extension of themselves. These friends share relatable experiences and the benefit and wisdom of each other's triumphs and tests. More importantly, they will feel that they understand each other, providing a fundamental kind of partnership.

Common ways these friends bond include:

- **Sharing their lives.** "I had the most amazing thought the other day..." is often heard in Campaigner-Diplomat friendships. In some sense, their honest, sincere friendships offer them a chance to live two lives at once. As curious and adventure-seeking as they are, Campaigners often take the lead in such friendships, opening exciting doors for their friends.
- **Giving compassionate support.** Diplomat friends readily care for each other in times of trouble, each knowing what the other needs and when they need it. Knowledge of each other's temperament,

combined with their caring nature, make them each other's ideal confidants. Sometimes they offer comfort, advice, and sympathy. At other times, they may offer gently pointed feedback, pushing for growth even as they offer support.

It may seem flip to say that it takes one to know one, but Diplomats are wonderfully suited to understand each other's unique combination of imagination and empathy. When their friendships stay honest, they can easily last a lifetime. But these friendships aren't all about feelings, as positive ideas often take center stage.

A Creative Bond

When it comes to pursuing creativity and fun together, Campaigners find that other Diplomats make enthusiastic and inspiring friends. In fact, mutual interests may be the reason they meet in the first place, being the initial step toward a deeper friendship. Diplomats don't merely "hang out," they connect.

Campaigners strive to express insights in creative ways and explore the world around them. Here are some key ways that other Diplomats make ideal partners in such endeavors:

- **Offering inspiration.** Campaigners inspire Diplomat friends with their energetic curiosity and love of novelty. This potential can come from core similarities that drive these types in compatible, but not necessarily identical, directions. Such differences aren't to be feared. In fact, they can hold special benefits. By weaving together harmonious but separate paths, Diplomat friends glimpse different points of view and profound insights through each other.
- **Balancing traits.** Diplomat friends with different traits are a special gift to Campaigners. While Campaigners' flexibility and lack of conformity can pay off creatively, they can also create instability. Judging Diplomats who reach a trusted level of influence with Campaigners can perhaps help them meet their goals. And quite simply, Introverted Diplomat friends can help loud-living Campaigners find quiet moments to appreciate the beauty of going within.

All of these wonderful contrasts combine with Campaigner and Diplomat friends' similarities to create a joyful whole. Whether these friends are reveling in wordless synchronicity or cheerfully tugging each other in fresh directions, both can find delight. These friendships can truly become greater than the sum of their parts, if both friends contribute appropriately, but are not without potential weak points.

Unbalanced Campaigner-Diplomat Friendships

Wrapped Up in Each Other

A key challenge for Campaigners and their Diplomat friends can come from the same source that fuels their bond – their similarity and their shared empathy. Having friends who think the same way is reassuring and comfortable, but it can also isolate them from contrasting opinions, unexpected knowledge, and personal growth.

Some unappealing potentials of these friendships include:

- **Emotional bubbles.** Campaigners, for all their social vigor and openness, aren't immune to assuming defensive positions; they may decry anything that seems to threaten their or their friends' beliefs or feelings. Campaigner-Diplomat friends sometimes build well-intentioned barriers around their friendships, waving aside unpleasant realities in favor of bolstering one another's emotional welfare.
- **Echo chambers.** Mutual protectiveness can block the corrective effects of fresh perspectives, causing stagnation or even perpetuating harmful views. Having a "yes person" as a constant companion when sometimes the right answer is "no" can be a great, if unintentional, disservice. The lure of having a friend who thinks everything they do, say, and feel is wonderful can dull even the most open mind.

It's rare that Campaigners and Diplomats would knowingly do anything to hinder each other's progress in life, but their desire to shield each other from pain isn't always beneficial. Growth can be painful, and unpleasant things are sometimes a productively necessity in life, no matter how hard it is to see a friend in distress.

Unconscious Influence

Their intense emotional connection might also lead Campaigner and Diplomat pals to unconsciously influence each other. However, they're not likely to pull the wool over each other's eyes in a calculated way.

Nonetheless, these types' influential bond with each other can go awry if they:

- **Lead each other astray.** If either of these types has an agenda that doesn't quite match the other's, they may subtly guide them, innately understanding what will influence such friends. Even unintended manipulation can be damaging, especially if it's in the guise of fun – a lure which Campaigners are particularly vulnerable to.
- **Exploit each other's trust.** Diplomats often accept influence from people they care about because they trust them implicitly, sometimes even becoming "people pleasers" in the face of their friends' desires. This can go either way, but with their bold energy, Campaigners can easily find themselves in powerful positions with their friends. Neither party may even be aware of any unfairness, simply accepting their place in the pattern.

Friends can harm each other if they don't give due consideration to the other's interests, even when trying to do what seems right. And Diplomats may be especially hesitant to risk their emotional harmony with each other by confronting any imbalance in a friendship. But no types are better suited to taking an honest look at their interaction and building a stronger, more respectful friendship.

Rebalancing Campaigner-Diplomat Friendships

Engaging Diversity in the Real World

In closed systems, it can be hard to grow not only as individuals but as friends. Stepping beyond their bubbles into real-world experiences together can make friendships between Campaigners and other Diplomats more complete. And Campaigners are perfectly suited to take the lead in this. Expanding their comfort zones helps these friends discover fresh ideas and new activities, something Campaigners thirst for.

One of the quickest ways to bring diversity into their shared social lives is for these friends to mingle with types of people from different backgrounds who challenge their views. Campaigners are social, but they don't always seek out those who bring a dose of contrast into their lives. Pushing that boundary in the company of trusted Diplomat friends can be an eye- and mind-opening experience.

Exploring different ideas and points of view is meat and drink to Campaigners, and while they don't have to accept everything they discover, they can certainly find grains of truth even in the most unlikely places. Opening their friendship to outside perspectives can be enlightening, and may even draw in new friends.

Here are some steps these friends can take to freshen their social perspective:

- Identify a social event around something unfamiliar, challenging, or even slightly dubious – a class or seminar on a weird subject or a gathering for an unfamiliar cause are just a couple of bold ideas.
- Schedule and engage in this event together.
- Agree to set aside shared opinions for the duration and merely observe and absorb.
- Ask questions and try to learn as much as possible.
- Be respectful to unfamiliar people and invite them into positive, constructive exchanges.
- Get contact information for people who are interesting, and who may become friends.
- Go somewhere afterward to discuss the experience together in full Intuitive glory.

There's nothing wrong with supporting each other with reassurance and agreement, but if that's the entire friendship, Campaigners and fellow Diplomats can't reach their full potential. Sometimes, coming closer requires shaking things up; Campaigners are glad to do so if it'll help a good friend.

Preventing Unintentional Manipulation

Campaigners don't want to be manipulated, nor do their values allow them to feel comfortable with manipulating other people. There's a difference between persuading friends and pressuring them, and respecting feedback makes most of the difference. Campaigners and other Diplomats can prevent this unintentional manipulation from taking place by saying "no" to each other in gentle but clear ways, and truly honoring each other's best interests.

These types have great internal compasses, but it's perfectly OK if their directions don't always align. Before pushing for or agreeing to an agenda, they can ask themselves what feels right in their hearts, and respect each other's answers to that question. It's vital for these friends to be direct, rather than trying to guide each other through subtle emotional engineering.

When communication is heartfelt, it flows freely, and any unconscious tendency to manipulate each other evaporates. Instead of pressure or cajoling, true needs and concerns can shine through with simple, fair language. There's nothing wrong with trying to infect each other with motivation, energy, and ideas, or even making requests, if both can be honest.

Here are some steps that can keep such communication above-board:

- Before trying to convince each other to go in any direction, consider whose interests will be served.
- Honestly assess personal reasons behind recommendations to friends; is it truly about them?
- Don't shy away from personal motivations. Share them honestly.
- Be direct and truthful when giving advice, criticism, or trying to convince friends.
- Make it easy for friends to be open. Listen fairly and kindly when they're sharing advice, direction, or preferences.

- Make it easy for friends to say "no," especially when they've listened fairly and kindly to what's been said.
- Thank each other for the care behind the words, even if agreement isn't mutual.

Rebalancing unconscious manipulation doesn't require Campaigners or their Diplomat friends to sublimate their own desires and motivations. They just need to work on sharing them in clear, open ways rather than through subtle strategies. Both types can appreciate a sense of relief when instinctive emotional pressure is replaced with honest give-and-take.

Campaigner-Sentinel Friendships

Campaigners and Sentinels as friends are a study in contrasts. But one thing they do have in common is a sense of responsibility to others. For Campaigners, this comes from a sense of social idealism. For Sentinels, it originates from a more practical place: these types focus on reliability. Sentinels are custodians of responsibilities who take their social and moral values seriously. Campaigners respect this. While their impassioned diatribes and imaginative ideas might make their Sentinel friends roll their eyes, both types nonetheless share a desire to improve the world.

Balanced Campaigner-Sentinel Friendships

Stabilizing Each Other

Campaigners benefit from the sense of stability Sentinels offer, and in turn give their ready support. While Sentinel friends may not be able to convince Campaigners to studiously attend to the mundane details of life, they can offer a responsible influence by way of example. In turn, Sentinels can trust their Campaigner friends to boldly step in and aid them when the unexpected threatens their sense of stability.

The benefits these friends give each other are different yet equally valuable:

- **Practical focus.** Campaigners are often taken with a steady procession of dreams and ideas they have yet to realize. Their boisterous lack of focus can frustrate their goals – and sometimes those who depend on them. Sentinel friends, whose steadfastness can weather chaos with great patience, can be very grounding and helpful. Sentinels provide a steady, sensible hand to help Campaigners move forward.
- **Resilient support.** Sentinels are often distressed when chaos intrudes into their lives, their comfortable rules easily upset by sudden changes. Campaigners' adaptability and empathy are the perfect support to help Sentinels persevere through such situations. Moreover, Campaigners are quick to step in and lend their active imaginations and vigorous assistance to set things right.

In this friendship, marked differences in their approach to life are a huge advantage to both Sentinels and Campaigners. By respectively being good at establishing order and good at adapting when that order breaks down, these two types of friends have the ability to strengthen each other no matter what happens.

Cutting Loose without Losing Control

Campaigners often seem like party animals compared to Sentinels, who tend to hold rigid views and have a need for predictability. Holding tight to such standards can be exhausting, but isn't without its merits. These friends can help each other have fun yet avoid going too far only in their preferred directions.

Balancing each other's respective tendencies can look like:

- **Opening up.** Campaigners can bring some needed fun into Sentinels' lives by showing them that dreaming beyond known boundaries can enhance life. Campaigners have a way of drawing Sentinels into adventures that allow them to loosen their inhibitions without losing who they are. They protect their Sentinel friends' feelings with immense compassion while also encouraging them to step out of their rigid limits.
- **Avoiding the ditch.** If Campaigners get carried away by their outgoing enthusiasm – and they often do – they can be sure that their Sentinel friends will let them know. Having such a thirst for exploring life, Campaigners easily get caught up in questionable pursuits that may end up being riskier than they're worth. Sentinel friends can see this a mile away and suggest a few prudent adjustments to their friends' headlong trajectory.

One of the best things about friendship is that neither friend needs to adopt the other's way of engaging life to feel its benefits. As their friendship deepens, these types learn to appreciate each other's pace and way of engaging life enough to let them influence their own, at least some of the time. Of course, this requires a willingness and patience on both their parts that isn't assured.

Unbalanced Campaigner-Sentinel Friendships

Differences in Engaging Activities

Often, these two types simply don't understand each other's attitudes, which can seem foreign to the point of being unworkable. Even when these friends share strong common interests, the different ways they pursue those interests can be tough to reconcile.

Possible problems in this area include:

- **Abandon meets reserve.** Campaigners' spontaneous, energetic approach to fun can seem like pure chaos to more reserved Sentinels. In turn, Campaigners might not understand their friends' reluctance to dive impulsively into every new idea and experience.

If these pals can't maintain cheerful patience, the result is often frustration.

- **Willfulness.** Disagreements over how to spend time together are likely if either type becomes too determined that they're right – and both tend to be strong-willed in such matters. Campaigners can be insistent and Sentinels can be firm, neither wanting to give up their preferred style of doing things. Sentinels may chidingly expect Campaigners to accept timely planning, while Campaigners may patronize Sentinels by insisting that they "relax."

Such urgings can go nowhere fast when these friends are unwilling to compromise, eventually chafing enough to limit their fun together.

Lack of Respect

For people of both types, their core differences can become a problem when they judge each other beyond simple disagreement. Disapproval and disrespect between these friends often center around the way they live their own lives. In ways they'd never say outright, each of these types can fall into a habit of mentally devaluing the other in disrespectful, and ultimately hurtful, ways.

Triggers for this kind of judgment may be as distinct as the friends themselves, and can come from either side:

- **Vocal resentment.** Campaigners' feelings and opinions are vivid, and they can get fired up with outrage just as easily as enthusiasm. When they judge too harshly, Campaigners may see Sentinels as limited beings who accept the mundane and resist change at every turn. Campaigners are all about engagement, and if they feel that Sentinels disapprove of them, they may voice their offense with vigor.
- **Resolute disapproval.** Sentinels, however, are extremely difficult to pry out of their point of view. They have solid reasons for their convictions, and they can resent anyone who tries to change their mind. When they feel justified in their judgment, they can be immovable. At an extreme, Sentinels may unfairly see Campaigners as childishly deluded and unable to accept fundamental priorities.

Whether it's subtle sniping, joking comments, or silently indicting each other with a pitying headshake, an inability or unwillingness to understand each other damages their friendships. When either of these types let their judgment get out of control, it can get ugly.

Rebalancing Campaigner-Sentinel Friendships

Finding Workable Compromises

Learning to align different approaches to activities requires both compromise and tolerance. Sentinels can learn to be more flexible when their Campaigner friends want them to join in an inspired idea. Campaigners, in turn, can ensure that Sentinels have an equal say in how they engage activities together. Sometimes Sentinels just need a moment to get their heads around something, and if they're given that time they'll gladly follow Campaigner friends toward fun.

Highly adaptable, Campaigners can use their go-with-the-flow energy to allow Sentinels leeway in planning out activities together, or even helpfully dive in ahead of time to gather information. It's also appropriate for these friends to sometimes do things without a schedule, adapting as they go with respectful communication. Patience doesn't always come easily to Campaigners, nor spontaneity to Sentinels, but both get better results with lightheartedness.

Some steps to keep in mind that can help enable workable compromises include:

- Divide up the work: Campaigners can pitch fun ideas. Sentinels can head the planning of these experiences.
- Engage the experience together.
    - Intentionally check in with each other occasionally: "How are we doing? Are we having fun?"
- Try and adapt to each other's needs when spending time together.
    - Campaigners can remain flexible enough to cheerfully rethink activities when Sentinels hit their limits.

  - Sentinels can push themselves out of their comfort zones without feeling trapped, knowing Campaigners will respect their needs.

- Communicate about what's fun and what isn't. There's usually overlap somewhere, and finding it can be a fun adventure when both friends voice their needs.

Both types of friends can take a step into each other's timeframes now and then – they each have a good approach, for certain things. When it comes to recreation, Sentinels may find it an unexpected relief to let go of rigid control, and Campaigners can appreciate the benefits of staying on schedule when it comes to important matters.

Replacing Judgment with Respect

When judgmental attitudes arise between Campaigner and Sentinel friends, restoring warmth and camaraderie may require accepting boundaries between their individual lives and what they share together. Each type has the right to live as they see fit, and need only be concerned with compromise when it comes to their time together.

What seems like a limited existence to Campaigners may in fact bring great joy and prosperity to Sentinels. What looks like idealistic chaos to Sentinels may be a life of satisfying accomplishment for Campaigners. Arguing over who's right is a fruitless endeavor when each type finds happiness differently.

Neither needs to accept the other's ways for themselves, but it's important that they respect their friends' preferences and avoid imposing their own choices onto others. Conflicting styles only clash when forced together, and reasons for friction disappear when these friends take care to bring only their positive aspects to each other's lives.

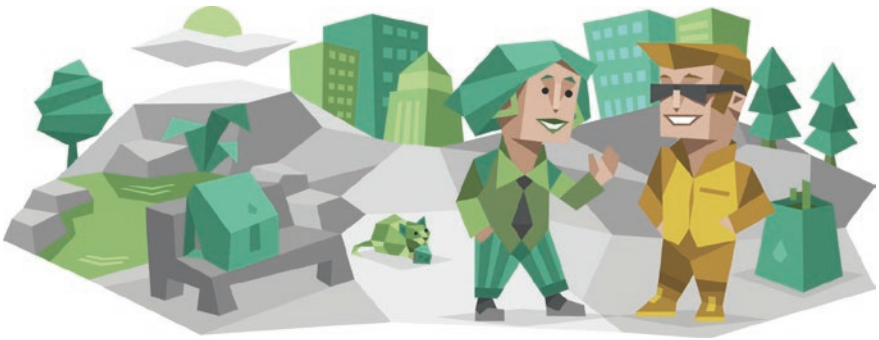
It's also important for Campaigner-Sentinel friends to quash any judgment with honest communication before things get heated. There's a big difference between expressing critical concern for each other and ladling out judgment, and both types should feel empowered to say when they feel that line has been crossed.

A simple exercise for Campaigners and Sentinels to ease judgment over their differences is to overlay them with positives that recognize each other's virtues, even if they're dissimilar. These steps can help:

- Independently, write 5–10 beneficial things that each friend brings to the friendship (i.e., a great sense of humor, always willing to drive, creates a sense of caring, thinks of fun ideas for activities, always reliable, keeps shared secrets, gives good advice, buys coffee, cooks great food, solves problems).
- Independently watch for instances of these positive acts, adjusting their list as needed.
- Show verbal appreciation for each instance.
- Mention the feeling created by each positive act. Keep it brief and casual.

These types each have some inescapable, marked core differences, but unless they're trying to live each other's lives, there's no reason they can't enjoy deep and happy friendship together where they share the positives and work through the rest. Caring for each other gives them a reason to compromise and to respect their need to be themselves.

Campaigner-Explorer Friendships



Campaigners have some spontaneous, unrestrained instincts in common with Explorers. They are likely to have very enjoyable friendships, especially if they meet through mutual interests or activities. Like Explorers, Campaigners love to go in nonconformist directions and are flexible in their approach to life. These two share a great desire for personal freedom, although they may express it in

different ways with different motivations. They both like novelty and can enjoy bringing new things into their worlds together.

Balanced Campaigner-Explorer Friendships

Running Down a Dream

Both these types possess a kind of impulsivity that's similar in some ways. Campaigners can consider different paths in rapid-fire succession without needing to establish a single direction in which to go. And, as opportunistic pathfinders, Explorers are looking for the next new and exciting thing.

In a friendship, this compatibility shows itself in wonderful ways:

- **Chasing excitement.** While their motivations may be uniquely their own, each types' mode may feel familiar to the other, and they'll likely think nothing of dropping what they're doing to engage something exciting together. "Whim" and "indulgence" may be the words of the day when these friends get together, with their inspired ideas and curiosity blending into serious fun.
- **Unexpected discovery.** Campaigners and Explorers can also tap into each other's preferred kinds of adventures to discover things they may not find on their own. Campaigners have grand dreams and ideas that tend to include other people, and even society in general. Their idea of adventure may be eye-opening to Explorers more attuned to their personal interests and practices. In turn, such intent in personal goals can be like a microcosmic universe unto themselves, and Campaigners marvel when entering Explorers' worlds with them.

Simply put, when individuals of these types meet and get along, they are in for some amazing times together. But their embrace of spontaneity opens up not only nearly unlimited options for fun, but also learning and growth.

Exploring New Perspectives

Mutual activities are just the beginning of discovery for these friends, as they likely have fundamentally different ways of looking at things.

Their similarities make forming a friendship relatively easy, but as that friendship deepens these types may find they offer each other increasingly profound yet enjoyable experiences.

Some ways their differences can open doors for each other include:

- **Getting down to Earth.** Campaigners may find Explorer friends pulling them out of their dream worlds to experience a wondrously elemental side of reality. Where Campaigners might be fascinated by sculpture design, Explorer friends may hand them a chainsaw and invite them to carve a figure in a log, moving them from theory into a thrilling experience. Even in the midst of such earthy experiences, Explorers can benefit when Campaigners' lofty conceptual views show them new passions in life.
- **Reaching out.** Campaigners also love to share their enthusiasm for social progress and engagement. Explorer friends often focus on their own path, but the idealistic vigor of Campaigners can help them connect to other people, opening new doors of friendship and fun. Shared experiences can also reveal a deeper meaning, such as the satisfaction gained from positive activism.

While Explorers won't always want to have lengthy discussions about airy intangibles, they can appreciate and benefit from the compassionate example of Campaigners' positive intent. In turn, Campaigners can discover the benefit of setting aside their mental and moral fervor for a moment to focus on personal experiences in the practical world. But just as these types can open new doors of understanding to each other, there are some risks in this friendship.

Unbalanced Campaigner-Explorer Friendships

Running Amok

Every coin has two sides, and the flip side of unrestrained, enthusiastic liberty can be a lack of responsibility. One of the dangers baked into Campaigner-Explorer friendships is that neither type is likely to play the role of the grown-up in the room when it comes to soberly attending to less thrilling realities.

Their mutuality can do them a disservice when they:

- **Ignore everyday necessities.** Campaigners are intent on doing the right thing but may be unable to muster much concern for mundane practicalities. Explorers likewise have a hard time caring about something if it doesn't feed their immediate interests. As friends, these types may enable each other to embrace only the things that enthuse them, and mutually ignore those that don't.
- **Neglect each other.** Irresponsible behavior can also get between these friends. In their pursuit of good times, things like appointments and commitments to each other can fall by the wayside or even be forgotten. Whether it's changing arrangements at the last minute, arriving late, or bungling preparations for mutual activities, even these flexible types struggle to tolerate derailed plans when they happen frequently.

While adaptability might make these types cheerful "partners in crime," neither one appreciates it when their mutual carefree inconsistency turns around to bite them. They're likely to be forgiving most of the time, but eventually may resent being let down by each other.

Contrasting Personal Priorities

Campaigners often have high ideas of what's right and all the amazing things they hope to bring about in the world. Explorers tend to be more enthused by tangible experiences that relate directly to their own lives. But while Explorers often have a "to each their own" attitude, Campaigners like to inspire everyone around them with the same passion they have for things.

Such differences have the potential to interfere with friendship when either of these types:

- **Gets pushy.** When Explorers are pushed too hard to care about things that seem distant and unimportant to them, they may push back with disdain. They dislike pressure or being told how they should think and act. Campaigners don't always fully understand the extent of Explorers' individualism. They may take any pushback as a rejection of the ideals and principles they believe in as universal.

- **Gets resentful.** Campaigners can resent it when Explorers don't join in their enthusiasm, whether it's about moral codes, emotional connection, or broad idealism regarding society. They may even view such friends as being base or selfish for not sharing their chosen ideals, even if those friends simply want to maintain their own free views. And when they feel judged, Explorers may resent or even call out Campaigners as absurdly idealistic.

Campaigners often want to be a part of positive social progress, but challenging Explorers' personal inclinations with arguments of principle only leads to frustration for both. But, given their traits, these types don't need to agree on everything to respect and enjoy each other.

Rebalancing Campaigner-Explorer Friendships

Creating Responsible Friendships

Campaigners and their Explorer friends may never be highly moderating influences on each other, but if they truly care about one another, they won't enable harmful behavior. Neither wants to see the other's life in shambles. While they might lack the skills to regulate each other, they can offer positive influences and perspective. These types see consequences but don't always rein in their fun long enough to talk about them soberly. However, learning to look beyond the excitement of the moment can safeguard their friendship for years to come.

Respect between these friends is partly a concern about each other's risky choices, but also a scrupulous way of treating each other. If there's ever a good reason to tighten up on self-discipline and consistency, it's for the sake of good friends who are sources of joy. It starts with communication: making a bold commitment to each other, speaking when something seems dubious or troublesome, and evenly discussing conflicts between each other.

Each type must find their own source of willpower, and the following steps can help:

- Imagine friends as loved ones to be cared for; make them family.
- Consider each other's choices and actions as if from a parent's or older sibling's perspective – caring oversight.

- When something seems risky, take time to fully talk about it.
- Learn from each other's mistakes, and gently remind each other when unproductive habits are likely to be repeated – and what was learned from previous instances.
- Don't try and control each other's behavior, just offer nonjudgmental insight and concern.
- Make statements mutual: "I wonder if *we* should be more careful..."

An inexhaustible well of care helps Campaigners' muster maturity and moderation. Once they view responsibility in the context of caring for their friends, they take it seriously. When Explorers see that irresponsibility is interfering with their fun, they'll quickly adapt and do what's needed to preserve their freedom and happiness.

Know When to Be Permissive

Campaigners often try to inspire people toward high-minded principles. Explorers tend to focus on creating palpable benefits as they enjoy and care for their friends. Neither should be made to feel judged for this difference. It's important for Campaigners to realize that not everyone shares their form of idealism, and it's unfair to make their personal ideals seem obligatory. Campaigners can use their empathy to accept when Explorer friends may have something of a different nature to contribute to the common good.

In turn, Explorers can tap into their famous curiosity and try something new. Sometimes, the answer to, "Why would I bother doing that?" is the realization that good friends are worth a little energy and fun is a state of mind. Explorers often have great success once they set their sights on something. They can tune into Campaigners' enthusiasm and pitch in with their company. Such efforts can be very meaningful to Campaigners and affirm their friendship.

Allowing each other their own direction in life is a necessary and fair manifestation of respect in Campaigner-Explorer friendships. This is especially true when it comes to perceived societal obligations versus personal priorities. Ultimately, having a good time together is more important than doing everything together, so time apart is sometimes also a good option.

To help preserve a balance, both friends can use these tips:

- Invite each other into personal priorities with cheerful enthusiasm.
- Highlight the possible fun and benefits with "we could" instead of "you should."
- Be open-minded about trying things the other cares about.
- Give fun a chance to show itself before dismissing something as boring or irrelevant.
- When either friend declines to do something, be cheerfully understanding – there's no need to ask for a reason.
- Respect each other's pursuit of personal priorities without judgment – people are different.
- Accept that being good friends doesn't require doing everything together.

These two types often become friends through a mutual love of excitement and exploration, and trying to push personal agendas can simply kill their fun. Instead, their combined energy is better spent in areas of common interest, reveling in what can be happily shared together as often as possible.

Conclusion

Social Nobility

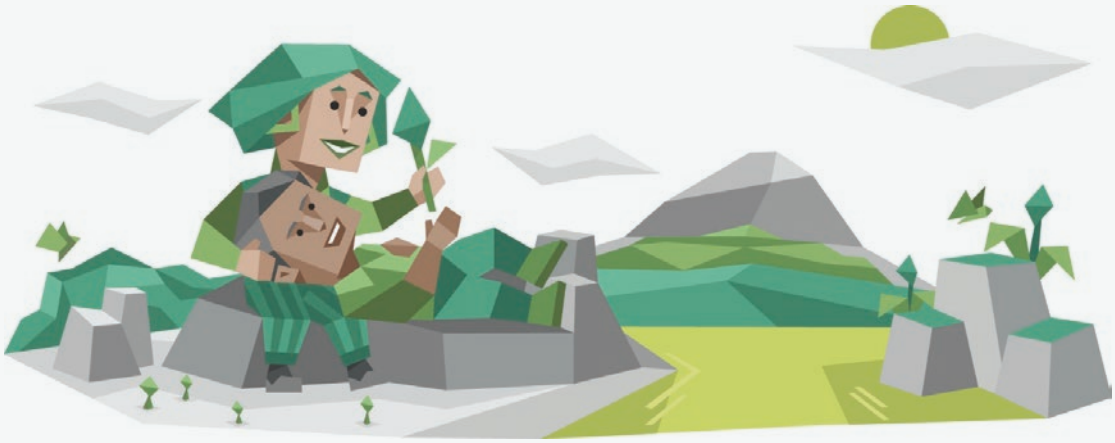
We've discussed some pitfalls Campaigners may face in their friendships, but in truth, this personality type can be adept at creating and maintaining social relationships. They can find something to appreciate in any type, valuing people and extending kindness and warmth to all. And when Campaigners want to invest in deeper friendships, their outgoing nature gives them substantial charm.

Given their strong social abilities, any difficulties that Campaigners face in friendships are often partly their own creation. Like all Intuitive types, they may get so blinded by their own visions that they lose touch with basic everyday factors, like other people's perfectly natural limits and differences. These types love and are very good at sharing their

inspired energy. When someone isn't easily caught up or influenced, they may view it as a failure, flaw, or need. But people don't need a cure for being who they are.

Campaigners have the ability to grow enough to accept others as the unique kinds of friend they are. With such growth, conflict fades, and these types find themselves mostly having fun with people and learning from them.

When Campaigners project the underlying tone of excitement for life that comes so naturally to them, they can befriend anyone. Studious, logical thinkers, reserved traditionalists, and self-assured gadabouts are all equally charmed. Indeed, Campaigners have the potential to create fulfilling social relationships that are nearly unlimited in both depth and breadth.



Romantic Relationships

When it comes to romance, Campaigners have stars in their eyes. Whether they're looking for love or nurturing existing relationships, these types believe in the power of love. Romantic idealists, they aim to build relationships full of warmth, joy, and acceptance, where both partners feel free to speak their most profound truths.

Here are some of the gifts that Campaigners bring to their relationships:

- **Vibrant energy.** These Extraverts offer their partners bright enthusiasm and joy, using their vivid imaginations to keep things lively. This makes early dating fun and keeps the spark alive as their relationships mature.
- **Radical openness.** Unreserved in their love, Campaigners delight in welcoming their partners into their lives. They see it as a privilege to learn about their beloveds' hopes, dreams, and desires, and they enjoy the magic of discovering others' perspectives on the world.
- **Gentle encouragement.** Campaigners' imaginative curiosity can be inspiring, even for stubborn or tradition-bound partners. Highly empathetic, Campaigners aren't likely to judge their loved ones, but through understanding and coaxing, they can easily make people think twice about their habits, opening them to new ideas and ways of being.
- **Willingness to adapt.** With their buoyancy of spirit, these types can stay accepting and optimistic even in the face of unforeseen or tumultuous events. All relationships face rocky patches, and this

combination of faith and goodwill helps Campaigners to stay the course while adapting as necessary.

- **Uninhibited love.** Campaigners aren't afraid to express their emotions, particularly positive emotions. Their partners can expect regular reassurances of love, affection, and gratitude.

Campaigners view relationships as deeply poetic and deeply romantic. That said, if these types don't embrace a healthy dose of realism, they may idealize their partners (or the idea of love more generally) to the extent that their relationships actually suffer.

Here are some challenges they may need to surmount along the way:

- **Frustrated ideals.** If they indulge in idealized fantasies of romance, then these types can struggle to reconcile their visions with the realities of everyday life. This can leave them tossing and turning in their beds at night, wondering, "Where did I go wrong?"
- **Blurred boundaries.** If they don't have balance in their lives, Campaigners may want to immerse themselves – lose themselves, even – in their romantic relationships. In these situations, they may find it hard to give their partners space, allowing neediness to blur healthy boundaries. For example, if their partners request some alone time, Campaigners might take it personally, viewing it as a hurtful and personal affront rather than a perfectly normal need.
- **Acting out.** All types face some insecurity in certain situations. For Campaigners, insecurities may arise when they don't feel as if they're really being seen (whether by their partners or by prospective partners). In response, these types might try to get validation by fishing for compliments or acting out to get attention.

Fortunately, as long as they recognize and address these tendencies, Campaigners can blossom (and encourage their partners to blossom) in any relationship. Campaigners overflow with encouragement and excitement, and they want to find partners with whom to share these sentiments. By balancing this desire with an appreciation of themselves and their partners as separate individuals, Campaigners can enjoy romantic relationships that feel fun and refreshing and yet deepen with time.

Potential Role Pairings

Unique Opportunities

Every personality type brings different things into romantic relationships, and knowing a little about what to expect from the various Role groups can help Campaigners get to know potential partners and build solid relationships. However, it's important to remember that people are infinitely unique regardless of their type, and there are no perfect romantic matches, even on paper.

Any two people who fall in love may get along wonderfully or have a few problems – in a healthy relationship, likely some of both. In the following sections, we'll provide guidance on how Campaigners and other types can better understand each other, as well as some of the more likely areas of conflict between them. Warm, encouraging, and adaptable, Campaigners can find balanced love with any other type.

Campaigner-Analyst Relationships

Love between Campaigners and Analysts often grows from the way these types balance each other's weaknesses and learn from each other's strengths. Linked by the Intuitive trait, both partners in these relationships can recognize the wonderful possibilities that the other brings into their shared lives, and the potential intrigues them. Campaigners think in terms of human connection, and Analysts in terms of rational processes. In each other, these imaginative types find not only a whole new way of thinking, but also new dimensions of themselves.

Balanced Campaigner-Analyst Relationships

Shared Imagination

Campaigners are known for inspired thinking, which creates a great way for them to connect with Analyst partners. Both types thrive on creative discussions, from sharing ideas about a product they're developing to explaining the intricacies of a book they've read. Complex and abstract ideas enthrall these pairs, and they can spend endless hours discussing philosophical topics or coming up with ideas.

Here are some of the ways that shared imagination manifests in these relationships:

- **The joy of brainstorming.** Who can match a Campaigner's delight in brainstorming? An Analyst, most likely. These two types know how to spin ideas out of thin air, and this shared enthusiasm keeps their conversations engaging and interesting.
- **Fresh eyes.** Campaigners have a capacity for treating everything as original. Whether it's people, ideas, or a math puzzle, they can approach it with fresh enthusiasm – dedicating an unbiased look to things others would just make assumptions about. This can easily earn the respect of Analysts, who appreciate fresh ideas but sometimes get locked in the loops of their own thinking.

Relationships between Campaigners and Analysts can be incredibly rewarding, as these individuals look at things from different yet somehow familiar perspectives. Bringing together Campaigners' human empathy with Analysts' interest in rationality, these relationships treat both partners to new vistas of exploration and understanding.

Discovering New Abilities

Campaigners can become lost in their feelings, especially during upsetting events. There are many moments in life when these types would be wise to step back, detach, and think about what's happening instead of being swept along by their feelings. With Analysts by their sides, Campaigners can learn the value of balancing the intelligence of their emotions with the intelligence of their rational minds.

Given this balance of strengths, these couples can be profoundly helpful to each other's growth in very real ways, such as:

- **Emotional expression.** Campaigners are perfectly suited to provide an example of emotional literacy, helping Analysts understand this side of themselves. Analysts have plenty of emotion, even if they don't know how to express it. Helping them to unlock and honor their feelings can be a meaningful, rewarding experience for Campaigners.
- **Maintaining momentum.** Campaigners feel drawn to share wondrous personal expressions of creativity with the world, but they can run out of steam when the first blush of enthusiasm wears off. Analyst partners can help Campaigners to reach their dreams by encouraging them to forge ahead on things that matter to them, even when they don't totally feel like it.

The balance that these two types bring to each other can translate directly into daily life, not just abstract concepts of growth. When it comes to unraveling the messy but important realm of emotions or staying on track toward long-term aspirations, these two can work together to help each other shine.

Unbalanced Campaigner-Analyst Relationships

Unspoken Intimacy

Campaigners value gestures of romance, intimacy, and affection, and they may see their Analyst partners as falling short in this regard. With their focus on rationality, Analysts may not see the point of expressing affection in these ways, leading them to forego romantic gestures or perform them with forced sincerity. Alas, Campaigners are easily disappointed and sometimes even hurt by these inauthentic efforts.

Here are some ways that differing attitudes toward romantic expression can become a key issue in Campaigner-Analyst relationships:

- **Missed connections.** Campaigners may miss the unexpected ways that Analysts do show their affection – for example, by troubleshooting a wireless router or offering advice on a longstanding issue. To Campaigners, these actions may seem prosaic rather than affectionate. This leaves them feeling unloved and neglected, even when their Analyst partners have the best of intentions.

- **Staying silent.** Like anyone, Campaigners have a right to express their needs, including their need for connection. Unfortunately, in an effort to stave off conflict, Campaigners may stay silent about their grievances. Unless Campaigners explain what makes them feel loved and appreciated, Analysts won't know how to meet their needs, leaving Campaigners feeling unfulfilled.

Analysts invest a lot of effort in prioritizing, but they may not prioritize emotional intimacy unless Campaigners bring up the issue. Campaigners might wish they didn't have to ask, but unless they express their needs and explain exactly what makes them feel loved, seen, and appreciated, Analysts may not know how to express their love in ways that resonate with Campaigners. If this pattern isn't addressed, Campaigners may become hurt and frustrated to the point that they explode with emotion, leaving Analysts even more confused.

Competing Approaches

When Campaigners and Analysts don't approach their values from the same perspective, ongoing and increasing friction can result. Unless they learn to balance their own perspectives with mutual respect and support, these two can grow apart.

Here are some ways that out-of-sync values may affect these couples:

- **Separate ways.** Campaigners prioritize emotional consideration over utilitarianism, and they want their partners to validate and support these values. Alas, many Analysts prioritize effectiveness and rationality over matters of feeling and connection, and so they may not understand or agree with Campaigners' humanitarian leanings.
- **Assuming the worst.** Campaigners might assume that Analyst partners who question their values and ideas are being dismissive, but that may not be the case. When Analysts say, "That's not realistic," or, "How would you do that?" they're often trying to express interest and curiosity – not disdain.
- **Fighting to be right.** Sometimes, Analysts *are* being dismissive. If they maintain their rational focus too narrowly, they'll shut down Campaigners' lofty ideas. In this situation, Campaigners can easily

become hurt or even resentful. They may even fight back, cutting down Analysts' ideas in return.

In romantic relationships, partners need to develop and maintain mutual respect even when they disagree or have competing values. Otherwise, they both may lose their sense of balance and start to resent each other for spending time, energy, attention, and money on things that don't seem "important."

Rebalancing Campaigner-Analyst Relationships

Improving Communication

Campaigner-Analyst couples can smooth over potential conflicts, especially early in their relationships, by working to understand their emotional differences. This process takes time and effort, but it can bring these two so much closer together.

An essential step for these two is to take in what the other says without immediate comment. Since Analysts are unlikely to respond with empathy naturally, deliberate reflection allows them to develop appropriate responses that support their partners' needs and feelings. In turn, Campaigners can use such contemplation to moderate the emotionality of their responses. When these couples practice being emotionally perceptive, they achieve a more complete form of intelligence that enhances their relationships.

To navigate this area of personal growth together, these couples can work on the following listening skills:

- Listen with full attention, rather than planning a reply while the other person is talking.
- Pause and take a deep breath before speaking. This can bring down tension levels, and it helps prevent interruptions.
- Before offering a dissenting opinion, ask clarifying questions.
- When conversations become heated, take a break to ask, "What can we learn from this conversation? How can we grow from it?"

- At the end of the conversation, thank each other for the willingness to consider alternative viewpoints and communicate about tough matters. End on a note of respect and gratitude.

In romantic relationships, both partners need verbal affirmations of respect and consideration. Even when these two don't agree, they'll appreciate knowing that the other is listening with a fair and open mind.

Learning to Accept Each Other's Priorities

Campaigners and Analysts may not fully agree with each other's priorities and values, but in healthy relationships, these two types need to respect and actively support each other, even when they don't see eye to eye.

Ideally, these couples can learn how to support each other's visions by drawing on their unique strengths. If Campaigners want to raise funds to help those in need, for example, Analysts can help them identify effective ways of doing so. And if Analysts want to test an idea of theirs, Campaigners can guide them to do so in a way that helps others.

This approach can have a multitude of benefits. Experiencing each other's passions directly goes a long way toward rebalancing differences – and there's always the chance of discovering they share one of their partner's passions. Neither partner type should feel obligated or pressured to spend their personal time on the other's interests, but they benefit greatly by at least trying them out.

Here's an action plan for these types to share their passions and values with each other:

- Harness the power of curiosity. Ask questions before making assumptions about each other's ideas and interests.
- Try to understand each other's broader goals and dreams before passing judgment. For example, ask, "What would you hope to gain by doing that?" (and listen carefully to the response!) rather than saying, "I don't see the point of that."
- Look for common ground. Identify areas of overlap between goals and values. Whenever possible, ask, "Is there a way I could help you with that?"

- Keep conversations constructive. If tensions become high or feelings get hurt, take a break to talk about something else (or spend a few minutes apart).

The core appreciation that Campaigners and Analysts feel for each other as individuals can be a source of motivation to balance their perspectives. These two might have different perspectives on the world, but in a loving relationship, each is happy to see the other fulfilled and excited – and to help each other live out their values.

Campaigner-Diplomat Relationships

Campaigners find a natural sense of connection with fellow Diplomats, often growing close with them quickly. Their commonalities can take the form of strengths, such as a caring nature. If left unchecked, though, these similarities can lead to issues, such as caring too much or indulging in emotional drama.

Fortunately, because they connect so well at the heart, Campaigners and other Diplomats in love have an incredible capacity to sustain each other for a lifetime.

Balanced Campaigner-Diplomat Relationships

Emotional Resonance

In this couple, both partners view the world in terms of emotions and relationships. This commonality can create an easy harmony, with both partner types expressing their thoughts and feelings in open and empathetic ways.

Here are some ways that Campaigners' and other Diplomats' emotional resonance can help them build meaningful relationships:

- **Easy attunement.** Thanks to their willingness to share feelings, these lovers quickly attune to each other's needs and desires. In turn, this empathy motivates them to *meet* those needs and desires. When two partners feel each other's emotions so strongly, it's only natural that they want to share as much joy together as possible.
- **Finally understood.** In the past, these partners may have felt as if they were swimming upstream through the world, trying to fit in among people who didn't seem to feel as deeply or care as intensely about others. In this relationship, these two may feel relieved to find that someone finally understands them and appreciates the beauty of their emotional nature.

It's true that sensitive, emotional people may occasionally find themselves at odds with one another. But when real love is present, they can use their emotional attunement to learn from such situations and be stronger for it. In this way, Campaigner-Diplomat couples who invest in long-term relationships find that their relationships can foster not only happiness but also personal growth.

A Pair of Dreamers

People of similar or even identical personality types are hardly the same. They almost inevitably have different interests, passions, and goals for their lives. That said, Campaigners and their fellow Diplomats *do* share some traits, including active imaginations and big dreams.

Even if they don't have the same interests, these couples support each other's dreams. Here are some ways that this dynamic enriches their lives, both as individuals and as loving couples:

- **A foundation of support.** Campaigners often struggle to follow projects through to completion, even when they're inspired. Having supportive romantic partners is an excellent way for these types to realize their own goals. Diplomat partners chiming in with positive energy can give them the push they need to move forward.
- **Joint opportunity.** Campaigners can also find their resolve strengthened when they work together with Diplomat partners on

mutual goals. If they balance their dreaming with a dose of realistic effort, these two can become partners in achievement as well as love.

Campaigners and their Diplomat partners believe in the beauty of their dreams. For these two, finding themselves in a relationship where the term "dreamer" is a compliment rather than a put-down can be an extraordinarily validating and empowering experience.

Unbalanced Campaigner-Diplomat Relationships

Emotional Burnout

As wonderful as strong, bonded emotions can be, maintaining such a deep connection and constantly catering to each other's feelings can become exhausting. If Campaigner-Diplomat couples lose their individual emotional stability, they may feel as if they can't function without (or within!) their relationship.

This leads to trouble, putting incredible pressure on the bond between these two. A relationship without sufficient emotional distance might show some of the following signs:

- **Needing constant validation.** It's fine to want attention, reassurance, and company from our partners. But these couples may be tempted to hitch *all* of their self-esteem to their relationship. Then, unless they receive constant validation from each other, they feel unlovable.
- **Loss of self.** To keep the relationship together, these two may be tempted to sacrifice their individual needs, interests, and traits. As a result, they may struggle to maintain a sense of self.
- **Disappointed ideals.** If Campaigners or other Diplomats lean too heavily on their relationships for emotional validation, they often end up idolizing their partners. As a result, when even minor flaws emerge (as they inevitably will), these types might overreact, questioning the relationships altogether.

Campaigners and fellow Diplomats tend to be vulnerable to having their high hopes dashed by reality. When the source of that disappointment

is the people they love, the damage is likely to be more unpleasant than mere disappointment. Unless they maintain a healthy sense of self-efficacy, these two can find themselves derailed when their relationship hits even the smallest of rough spots.

Lofty Distractions

Campaigner-Diplomat couples have a troubling tendency to distract each other from everyday realities. They often get lost in their worlds of ideas and possibilities, drifting from one grand concept to another while ignoring immediate concerns.

This can produce wonderful creativity and insight, but it might not result in stability. If they don't take enough time to live in the present and focus on simple realities, here are some consequences these two might face:

- **Frustrated ambitions.** When they get distracted and neglect practical matters, these two undermine their capacity to achieve their broader goals in the future. For example, if these two have to spend hard-earned savings on late fees, interest, and parking tickets, then they can't devote their resources and attention to their dreams.
- **Rose-colored disappointment.** Alternatively, these two might drain their resources to go after grandiose ideas. Without practical groundwork, planning, and consistent effort, however, these ideas will rarely work out. These couples may know how to hope for the best, but alas, "hoping" will only get them so far.

Lives spent fighting injustice or painting portraits may have tremendous moral and spiritual payoffs, but at some point, couples can feel their lack of pragmatism in very basic ways. Even the most idealistic of us need a roof over our heads and enough money to take care of ourselves in retirement.

Rebalancing Campaigner-Diplomat Relationships

Increasing Independence for Improved Emotional Strength

Partners who have lost their individual identities can rediscover them by developing their independence. One excellent way to cultivate

independence is to plan occasional fun activities apart from each other. Whether through solitude or time spent with friends and family, these romantic partners become better sources of strength for each other when they're strong on their own.

In codependent relationships, one partner may feel a crippling sense of abandonment when the other asserts their independence. That's a challenging issue, and it's a reason for these couples to plan some joint activities to balance out their solo adventures. That way, these two types can feel assured that their alone time won't come at the expense of their loving connection.

Here are some steps that can help counteract any codependent leanings:

- Identify a few areas where you have different interests. For example, one partner might love bowling, and the other might enjoy baking with friends.
- Set aside a block of time (say, a weekend afternoon) when both partners will pursue their individual interests.
- Understand that a partner's nonparticipation makes sense. If one person loves to deep-sea fish, but the activity bores the other, it makes perfect sense for the latter to sit the activity out.
- Take time alone to focus on personal thoughts and emotions.
- Balance time spent together and time socializing with others.
- Gently decline to participate in each other's negative emotions.
- Project supportive, positive feelings in the face of each other's upset.

There's no magic bullet to prevent or resolve strong negative emotions, but underlying care for each other can see these couples through conflicts. Practicing emotional individuality when times are good can give these companions some valuable strength to maintain their senses of self when times get rough.

Balancing Dreams with Responsibility

Campaigner-Diplomat couples need to balance their big dreams with the necessary realities of stocking the fridge and paying bills. Although

they may not love dealing with the practical details of life, this balance helps them to create a solid foundation for the things that matter to them.

One way to do this is to find time to participate in pragmatic activities on a regular basis – together. Working side by side on cleaning the house or heading out to run errands together are great ways for these lovers to tackle necessary (if less-than-glamorous) tasks yet still enjoy each other's inspired company.

When responsibilities come knocking, Campaigners and their beloved Diplomats can roll up their sleeves, put on some music, and try to make the work as fun as possible. Whether it's fixing a leak, cleaning a room, or creating a budget, these two gain momentum from working together with a cheerful attitude.

The will to accomplish responsibilities takes more than just instructions, but these steps can bolster these couples' commitment to getting things done:

- Every month, sit down for a brainstorming session. Create a list of necessary chores and to-dos, prioritizing any that are being overlooked.
- Pull out calendars to create a schedule for doing these tasks together.
- Lean on each other for accountability.
- Keep track of completed tasks to boost morale.

For types who love the realms of thought and imagination, it's important to keep daily life clear of distractions and stumbling blocks – from messy floors to overdue bills. By maintaining a pleasant, reliable home life, this type pairing creates the conditions they need to pursue their callings and be forces for good in the world.

Campaigner-Sentinel Relationships

Campaigner-Sentinel relationships often bring about a kind of consistent support that makes both types feel secure and very well cared for. Despite their different approaches to life, both types place tremendous emphasis on having deep and trusting love in their lives. This shared appreciation opens them up to learn from each other's differences and grow into their best selves.

Balanced Campaigner-Sentinel Relationships

A Foundation of Mutual Support

Both Campaigners and Sentinels sincerely want what's best for people. In romantic relationships, this common ground helps them to see themselves as a team. Even when they disagree, they seek win-win solutions that maintain harmony (a priority for Campaigners) and stability (a major value for Sentinels).

The result? These couples are incredibly adept at compensating for each other's weaknesses – in harmonious, stability-enhancing ways. Here's how they do it:

- **The seesaw effect.** Sentinels can be an enormously grounding influence on Campaigners. Pragmatic, realistic, and detail oriented, Sentinels offer a stable perspective that helps Campaigners focus on practical matters that they might otherwise neglect.
- **Staying the course.** Sentinels don't give up easily. This trait may inspire their Campaigner partners to maintain momentum toward their own goals.

- **Chrysalis moments.** Campaigners provide their Sentinel lovers with a needed dose of inspiration and excitement. Campaigners' excitement and optimism can help Sentinels break out of their sometimes reserved shells and realize their own potential.

As long as they maintain an attitude of mutual respect, these two have what it takes to help each other through life's challenges. Sentinels can help Campaigners feel more grounded and secure, and Campaigners can help ensure that Sentinels don't stay cramped in a too-small life. In the process, both partners deepen their relationship *and* grow into their potential as individuals.

Building a Rich Life Together

Campaigners and Sentinels are attracted to the idea of lifelong, abiding love. Just as importantly, these two have the skills to support each other not just in the short run, but over the course of decades.

Here's how this couple can stand the test of time together:

- **Necessary structures.** As Campaigners mature, they recognize the difference between freedom and chaos. For them, true freedom comes from having the tools, resources, and discipline to go after their creative visions. Sentinel partners are perfectly suited to helping them establish the underlying structures necessary to pursue their ideas and goals.
- **Steady warmth.** Even the most sensible of Sentinels can feel hollow without warmth and companionship. Campaigners offer their romantic partners heartfelt devotion and appreciation. When the love of Campaigners enters their lives like a ray of sunshine, Sentinels can depend on having love at their side.

Campaigners and Sentinels are quite different – and that can be a good thing. These two types build more complete lives by embracing each other's differences and giving generously of their own virtues.

Unbalanced Campaigner-Sentinel Relationships

Frustration with Follow-Through

Romantic relationships don't always go as planned with these two types. Campaigners who don't balance their imaginations with pragmatism may find their Sentinel companions dismissing their flexible, optimistic visions as impractical. And when Sentinels let their frustration get out of hand, they may very likely hurt Campaigners with their criticism, especially because there may be some truth in it.

Here's how this dynamic can play out in their relationship:

- **Change of plans.** At first, Campaigners may impress Sentinels with their idealism. But in time, Sentinels may lose patience with Campaigners' seeming inability to complete a project. In this situation, Campaigners may feel hurt or unfairly judged.
- **Losing interest.** Frustration goes both ways. With time, Campaigners may lose patience with Sentinels' risk aversion. The word "boring" may even come to mind. Sentinels can appear rigid to Campaigners, as though they suffer from a lack of vision or ability to change.

When Sentinels cling to predictability, Campaigners may feel trapped or even suppressed. Meanwhile, Sentinels might decide that their Campaigner partners "*never* get anything done," leading to hurt and frustration all around.

Different Timetables for Living

Campaigners and Sentinels have potentially incompatible ways of engaging with experiences. Typical Sentinels come up with a detailed schedule that they stick to dutifully. For them, everything must be in its place and on time. In contrast, Campaigners prefer making things up as they go along, taking a very relaxed and flexible approach to engagement in the first place – things can happen "whenever."

These two types can get on each other's nerves, especially because their different approaches affect so many common aspects of life, like meeting for dates or handling rent payments. For couples in this situation, the following might sound familiar:

- **Don't bring me down.** Campaigners may feel controlled or even annoyed when their Sentinel partners pressure them to solidify or stick to their timetables. For Campaigners, taking life as it comes – and adapting along the way – is incredibly pleasurable. But for Sentinels, this approach can be profoundly stressful.
- **So much judgment.** When Campaigners change plans at the last minute (or refuse to make plans altogether), Sentinels might accuse them of being unreliable. Meanwhile, when Sentinels try to stick to a schedule, Campaigners might assume they're just being rigid.
- **Misunderstandings.** Without deeper understanding, it's hard for these two to find compassion for each other. For example, Sentinels might not appreciate the extent to which spontaneity enhances Campaigners' happiness. In turn, Campaigners might not understand just how much Sentinels' seeming stubbornness comes from a genuine fear of the unknown.

For any personality type, there's great value in balancing planning with adapting. When these types refuse to move toward such a combination, disagreements about which approach is "correct" can turn toxic.

Rebalancing Campaigner-Sentinel Relationships

Accomplishing Goals Together

Acting with the same creative spirit that drives their imaginations, Campaigners can follow through on the goals they share with their loved ones. These types have the energy to come up with ways to make diligence fun and rewarding – such as putting on music or "racing" against a timer instead of avoiding an unpleasant task.

Whether they're putting off laundry or filing their taxes, Campaigners in relationships with Sentinels can look to their steady, hardworking partners for support in getting things done. And Sentinels are often more than happy to help, providing the accountability and structure that Campaigners need.

That said, "support" isn't the same as "please do things so I don't have to." Campaigners can't foist off their responsibilities on their loved ones, even when those loved ones are hyperresponsible Sentinels.

Here's how Campaigners can work *together* with their partners to accomplish shared priorities:

- Identify a shared goal or priority, such as setting a budget or reorganizing a storage area.
- Have both partners weigh in on why this goal matters in the big-picture sense. What are the long-term benefits of achieving this goal?
- Next, have both partners brainstorm stumbling blocks that could get in the way of their achieving the goal – for example, not tracking progress or not identifying important milestones.
- Together, go through the potential stumbling blocks one by one. Using creativity and practical insight, identify strategies for avoiding these blocks.
- Next, pull out a calendar and have both partners identify *what* they will do in pursuit of the goal and *when* they will do it.
- Finally, agree on a system for regularly checking in and maintaining accountability – for example, discussing progress toward the goal during dinner on Sunday nights.

With a strong commitment to each other, these two partners have the capacity to be remarkably supportive. Creativity and stability need not be at odds if Campaigner-Sentinel partners are willing to harness their time, energy, and talents toward shared goals.

Finding the Best of Both Worlds

When it comes to the scheduled versus unscheduled approaches to life, there's no "right" answer. Each of these approaches is valid, and each is appropriate for certain situations. For Campaigners and Sentinels to live together in harmony, they need to respect each other's approach to scheduling and, for shared activities, decide *together* which approach is most appropriate for the situation.

This rebalancing becomes much easier in the presence of compassion. With time, Campaigners can come to realize that Sentinels' desire for scheduling control comes from a fear of the *what-if*, not a distaste toward the Campaigner personality itself. Once this recognition dawns on Campaigners, they might have compassion for Sentinels' desire to

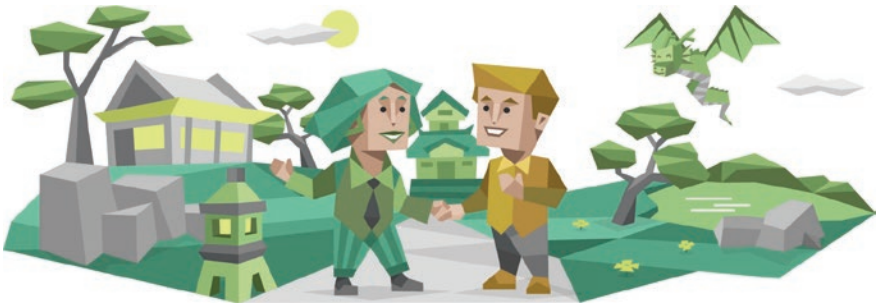
stay in their comfort zones. And once Sentinel partners appreciate how much joy and life it brings their Campaigner partners to adapt to the moment, they may relax their rigidity in return.

Here are some tips for creating workable compromises:

- Schedule unscheduled time. This might sound like an oxymoron, but it doesn't have to be. Set aside a specific block of time – say, two hours on a Sunday – for unstructured fun, exploration, and/or relaxation.
- As a couple, check in after the unstructured time, discussing what you did and how it felt. What felt good? What was fun? What was uncomfortable?
- Use insights from these check-ins to guide the next week's unstructured time.

This arrangement allows Campaigners to enjoy uninhibited time. Meanwhile, Sentinels can let loose because they've *planned* to take this time off. Together, these two can enjoy the best of both worlds when it comes to planning. Sentinels may find unexpected relief when they let go of rigid control, and Campaigners can appreciate the benefits of staying on schedule when it comes to important matters.

Campaigner-Explorer Relationships



The Campaigner-Explorer pairing is one of fun and adventure. This couple's differences combine in exciting, sometimes enthralling ways. Campaigners have heads full of creative dreams, and Explorers tend to like hands-on ideas and activities. Love itself expands this couple's horizons as they introduce each other to new and delightful things.

Balanced Campaigner-Explorer Relationships

Exploring Reality Together

On their own, Campaigners can get lost in their imagination. For these types, the world of hypothetical ideas and dreams is so vibrant and appealing that they may just get stuck there. But with Explorers by their sides, they quickly find themselves drawn out of their heads and into the world. For Campaigners, the novelty of being in the moment can feel like an incredible discovery, adding new dimensions to the love they share with Explorers.

Here's how this couple can uncover fresh terrain together:

- **Bet you didn't know...** Unusual concepts appeal to both Campaigners and Explorers. When it comes to creativity and ingenuity, these significant others serve as unique sources of inspiration for each other. In this dynamic, Campaigners provide a principled, highly imaginative perspective, and Explorers get excited to put ideas into a real-world context to see how they work.
- **Novel pleasures.** Together, these types take an interest in exploring everything: they're always looking for what's new and exciting. Sharing a wonderful sense of curiosity, these two can build for themselves a world of exploration. When you combine Campaigners' faith that all is possible with Explorers' willingness to take action, the result is rarely predictable but often joyful.

This pairing can result in lots of enjoyment and adventure. As a result, not only are the early stages of dating a delight, but these two know how to keep things fresh as their relationship matures and deepens.

Freedom Together

Another quality that Campaigners and Explorers share is a love of freedom. To be happy, Campaigners need to feel as though they can dream and create without restraint. Likewise, Explorers want to walk their own paths by engaging pursuits that are important to them.

Although they may have different targets and approaches, these couples share an essential desire to follow their hearts and minds wherever they may lead. Here's how this shared trait can strengthen their relationships:

- **Yes, you can.** These couples express their love through supporting each other's liberty and passions. Whereas some types might feel compelled to impose structure or restrictions, these lovers know when to say, "Go for it, babe!"
- **Taking necessary space.** All relationships need *some* amount of space. If two people smother each other, the flame of their love will weaken. In healthy relationships, Campaigner-Explorer couples empower each other to take the space they need to pursue their individual interests.

These couples don't hold each other to rigid standards or convention by any means. Both types are willing to adapt to new things all the time, even seeking them out by preference. When they support each other's interests, Campaigners and Explorers in love can find endless happy adventures together.

Unbalanced Campaigner-Explorer Relationships

Why Don't You Understand Me?

Despite their shared curiosity and adaptability, Campaigners and Explorers have some significant differences when it comes to imagination versus practicality. Campaigners who take their imagination too far can essentially end up living in a world of self-affirmed realities and deferred actions. This can make even the most flexible and permissive Explorer lovers shake their heads in vexed wonderment.

Here's how this dynamic can pose challenges to their relationships:

- **A rose by any other name.** These two have divergent styles of thinking and communicating. Explorers may lose patience with Campaigners who often wax too poetically for their liking. In turn, Campaigners may see Explorers as limited in their ability to consider and express abstract concepts.
- **Do or do not.** Explorers love to *do*, and Campaigners love to *imagine*. For Campaigners, half the pleasure of life comes from considering different alternatives and possibilities. As a result, Campaigners may wonder why Explorers are so dismissive of the

things that are important to them, whereas Explorers might worry that Campaigners overthink everything.

These beliefs can cause great hurt in each partner type, leading to arguments and resentment. To break out of this pattern, these partners need to appreciate how each other thinks – and then decide to understand each other during disagreements.

Shifting Sands

Campaigners and Explorers are happy to dive headlong into change – and that can result in a great deal of shared risk. Yes, it's wonderful to throw caution to the wind every now and then, but sometimes we *need* a bit of caution to keep the mechanisms of our lives running smoothly.

Here's how these couples might fare if they don't prioritize building a stable foundation for their lives:

- **Arrested development.** These couples' love of novelty may distract them from less thrilling (but no less important and rewarding) investments in themselves and their future. Prosperity, long-term success, and the achievement of dreams often require steady commitment and efforts that don't immediately pay off.
- **Putting off responsibilities.** These two may be tempted to shirk responsibilities – which is fine, until the water gets shut off because the bill's still sitting on the counter. Delayed gratification isn't an easy skill to build, but in the long run, it's necessary.
- **Unsteady foundations.** Whether failing to decide on an area of study, switching jobs too often, or simply frittering away their time and money on passing pleasures together, Campaigners and Explorers might build their futures on shifting sands rather than a solid foundation. For couples who don't have infinite resources, this can pose a significant problem.

If these types let their novelty-seeking get out of hand, they may not stick to the same goals for very long. This may be fine in discretionary personal pursuits, but it can set them back in matters of long-term development, which are important to creating happy, successfully shared lives.

Rebalancing Campaigner-Explorer Relationships

Reconciling Differences to Improve Intimacy

For Campaigner-Explorer couples to achieve balance, they need to reconcile their different approaches to life: airy, conceptual idealism on the part of Campaigners and hands-on practicality on the part of Explorers.

Fortunately, these couples' willingness to try new things offers them a clear path to accepting – if not always understanding – each other's styles. With a little tolerance and compassion, these two types can see the value in their different methods: Campaigners can see how well Explorers figure things out by direct engagement, for example, and Explorers can see how deeply insightful Campaigners can be using only their minds.

One of the biggest steps for these lovers is to realize that they each have priorities, and none are necessarily wrong. Campaigners can work to respect Explorers' focus on tangible accomplishments – they have every right to work on what matters to them. For their part in rebalancing, Explorers might consider applying their masterful abilities to helping their Campaigner partners evolve some of their high-minded ideas into reality – at least, the ones that *can* be translated into reality.

Here are some ideas to create balance in this area:

- Together, do an activity that directly translates idealistic beliefs into tangible action. Volunteering is a great option.
- Pay close attention to the experience. Why is it impactful? What actions seem to pay off the most? What are the intangible benefits of the activity? If appropriate, take photos or video, or jot down some notes.
- Afterward, go out as a couple to a place where it's easy to talk, such as a coffee shop or a park.
- There, discuss what made the experience feel worthwhile. Was it the larger concepts behind the activity, specific actions, or a combination of the two?
- Listen carefully to the other partner's perspective. Remember, nobody is wrong when they describe what made an experience meaningful (or not) to them.

The simplest way for these two types to reconcile their differences is to embark on shared pursuits with open hearts and minds. Neither partner type needs to convert, but they can listen carefully and respectfully when the other explains their perspectives and methods.

Building a Foundation for the Future

To achieve meaningful long-term goals, Campaigners and their Explorer partners need to take on their responsibilities *together*. Learning to tackle pursuits that are difficult or uninteresting is a sign of both personal maturity and a mature relationship. Fortunately, if there's any couple that can find the fun in budgeting, meal planning, or housekeeping, it's these two types.

Together, these two can prioritize what will make them happy and secure in the long run – find the joy in it. After all, these goals are for their benefit. It's a lot easier to go on vacation when you have money in the bank, and a nice dinner out tastes infinitely better when you know you don't have a mass of vegetables going bad in the back of the fridge.

In realistic terms, these couples need to dedicate some time every week to working on practical goals together. To help with goal-setting and engagement, these couples can:

- Start by identifying just two or three long-term goals that are important to both. What is the goal? Why is it important? What resources will it require?
- Define to each other what success would look like. How would completion of the goal be measured?
- Next, consider whether the goal is achievable – don't be afraid to ask trustworthy people with related experience for their opinions and advice.
- Commit to a schedule of when to work on the goal together.
- Work on the goal together with positive attitudes and encouragement toward each other. Look for ways to make this experience enjoyable and fun.
- Stick to the plan as much as possible, adjusting only for emergencies.

With a little shared focus and effort, Campaigner-Explorer couples can translate their desires into real-world results that keep them happy far into the future. If they work together, there's no reason they can't create some stability while enjoying spontaneous, lighthearted lives together.

Conclusion

Staying True to Their Hearts

With their enthusiasm and warmth, Campaigners can forge rewarding romantic relationships with any type. When they meet someone who truly appreciates and respects them in return, their love knows no limits.

As partners, Campaigners are deeply empathetic, thoughtful, and openhearted. They not only welcome their significant others into their lives but also accept those individuals just as they are. This radical acceptance often serves as a balm to their partners' self-esteem, setting an encouraging and uplifting tone for the relationships.

Given their sensitivity and empathy, Campaigners may struggle to uphold their boundaries. If there's any cautionary theme for Campaigners in love, it's not to lose themselves unreservedly in their adoration of their partners. If these types abandon their uniqueness and forgo their happiness as individuals in order to please their partners, their relationships will inevitably suffer.

Loving partners will want to give Campaigners what they need, but they can only do so if Campaigners actually communicate those needs – and how to meet them.

When Campaigners share their uniqueness and express their needs without shame, they may be surprised at how attractive they are to other people. Their ability to care for others on an emotional level, their insight, and their delightful spontaneity make them appealing to all types of potential partners.

If they learn to accept themselves as openly as they value their partners, Campaigners can help to build balanced and beautiful relationships – while also expanding their ability to love.

Parenthood

"Pure joy" is how most Campaigners would describe their idea of parenthood. Few types embrace the excitement of child-rearing as readily as Campaigner parents. Having fun, cutting loose, and enjoying time with others – especially their children – are things Campaigner parents embrace. Where many mothers and fathers may feel pressured to perform their parenting duties in a particular way, confident Campaigners have little fear of bucking the system.

Here are some of the traits that confident Campaigner parents share:

- **Inspirational attitudes.** Campaigners approach life with boundless energy and enthusiasm, an attitude that young children often share. Parents with this personality type wear their hearts on their sleeves and their emotions on their faces. This makes it easy for their children to understand whether their latest actions have won them favor or earned disapproval.
- **Endlessly optimistic.** These types don't dwell on the negative. Disputes between parents and children are resolved quickly. Conflicts become distant memories as soon as some new interests catch their imagination.
- **Always accessible.** Though Campaigner parents often have involved social schedules, they likely always have time to listen to their children on matters great and small. These parents can establish a rapport with their children that's enjoyable yet profound. This creates a bond that puts their offspring at ease even when discussing life's most sensitive problems.

These types find happiness only when others can share in it, and it's perhaps this trait more than any other that children of Campaigner parents benefit from most. Their eagerness to connect can become an issue, however, if it results in Campaigners' focusing solely on relating to their children instead of providing structure. This can bring about negative consequences, such as:

- **Creating chaos.** Campaigner parents who view setting boundaries as an unnecessary restraint often have a hard time understanding the value of consistency. Children that aren't provided the comfort of stability can become easily overwhelmed by this lack of routine and structure.
- **No time for downtime.** Though not exactly hedonistic, Campaigners can act as though life were one big party. Though these moms and dads shine when coaching soccer games or orchestrating mass sleepovers, they often fail to make time for everyone to rest and recharge.
- **Overly sensitive.** Few things are more hurtful to this sensitive personality type than seeing their beliefs challenged by their children. In such circumstances, Campaigner parents might blame themselves for being unable to instill the right values in their children.

Campaigners have one incredible strength that helps them to overcome the inevitable struggles that they may face as parents – their constant desire for growth. A passion for improving themselves translates into becoming better, more well-balanced parents. Once they have identified areas in their lives that would benefit from further development, there's no stopping them.

The following sections describe steps that Campaigner parents can take to address the issues discussed above.

Create Structure and Rhythm

Perhaps one of the most beneficial things Campaigner parents can do to build meaningful balance is to incorporate structure and rhythm in their kids' daily lives. Such creative types may balk at structure, equating that word with boredom and conformity. But when used correctly,

structure can provide *more* freedom to create and connect with their children. The adage, "In limits, there is freedom," holds true for children of all personality types who rely on their parents to set safe boundaries they can count on as they explore their world.

One way to create structure that is organic yet useful is to develop a daily rhythm. A daily rhythm is structured yet flexible, providing the consistency that children of all ages need. It also allows for spontaneity and time to stop and smell the proverbial roses. Unlike a strict schedule where every activity is planned down to the minute, a rhythm helps to create a natural routine that adjusts as needed.

The following steps can help Campaigner parents develop a daily rhythm that works for their families:

- Make a list of values or family priorities you will use as a guide for this activity.
- Determine what tasks *need* to be taken care each day – such as household chores – and when they should be done.
- Prioritize time each day to do at least one activity that aligns with your family values.
- Set aside at least one block of time with nothing scheduled each day and resist the urge to fill these spaces with activities.

Example: Your family values include quality time and love of learning. As part of your daily rhythm, you set aside time each day to spend with each other and to pursue educational activities, such as practicing a foreign language or painting. You schedule one hour in the morning and one hour in the evening to take care of necessary tasks like packing lunches or doing laundry. You also block off 30 minutes of "free time" each evening with nothing specific scheduled.

Appreciating the Silence

Every day need not be extraordinary – or, at least, not in the sense of parades and fireworks. Campaigner parents who attempt to pack in as many activities as humanly possible may find less fulfillment than those who give themselves and their children some time to relax and reflect. Fun is an experience best understood through contrast. A day

at the beach becomes more exceptional after spending the rest of the week in a windowless office. Even these Extraverted parents need time to process the flood of precious memories that they've spent every waking moment attempting to make.

One way to practice embracing the quiet is to set up time each week (ideally, at least a little time each day) to find some calm as a family. Try the following:

- Pick a specific time of day (or day of the week) that works best for engaging in some calming activities as a family.
- Do not allow these times to be infringed upon by outside activities. If something urgent comes up reschedule your quiet time as soon as possible.
- Plan a calming activity that the entire family can engage in.

Example: Dinner time works best for your family to engage with each other and enjoy some much-needed quiet quality time. Some evenings there are other engagements, like soccer practice or yoga class. But you schedule at least three nights each week where your family can enjoy dinner together uninterrupted. On at least one of those nights you might include a calming activity after dinner as well. These activities include family reading time or a quiet evening stroll through the neighborhood.

Being Emotionally Honest

Those with this personality type may have a hard time employing some of the punitive measures other parents rely on. Even listening to a toddler cry through a three-minute-long time-out can be as much a punishment for Campaigner parents as their children. When Campaigners are genuinely hurt by their kids' misbehavior, they may fail to discipline their children. They may shrug off their behavior as something that they can't (or won't) attempt to control.

To avoid engaging in behaviors that focus more on guilt or other emotional ploys, Campaigners can do the following to be more honest and effective parents:

- Tell your children how their behavior or actions make you feel in an honest, age-appropriate way.

- Discuss the potential consequences of their actions if they are out of line or inappropriate.
- Reassure your children that, despite your frustrations with their behavior, your love for them is forever.

Example: You have been struggling with your preschooler's behavior all day, and he just said that he hates you. Between struggling to get him to pick up his toys without a meltdown and the never-ending battle to get him to eat his broccoli at lunchtime, you are at your wits' end. Rather than erupting in anger, you say, "It really hurts my feelings when you say you hate me. I love you very much. I tell you to do things because I care about you and want you to be a good, healthy person. If you don't listen or say mean things, we will have to put a couple of your favorite toys away until you can be nice."

Parenting for Each Stage of Development

Each stage of a child's growth presents both unique challenges and exciting milestones. Learning how to navigate these stages can seem daunting, but the opportunity to build healthy attachments and create meaningful memories makes it worth the struggle.

Renowned psychologist Erik Erikson proposed a theory of psychosocial development that identified eight stages, five of which take place between birth and 18 years of age. It's important to remember these stages aren't set in stone, and the ages listed for each stage are *approximate*. Children develop at their own pace and meet each milestone in their own time. Whatever the stage of development, growth never stops.

The following paragraphs discuss what to expect at each stage of development. They also cover how the strengths and weaknesses of the Campaigner personality type can affect their parenting at each stage. Suggestions are also offered on how to help Campaigners turn an unbalanced approach around.

Building Bonds (From Birth to Approximately 1 ½ Years)

According to Erikson, the stages of infancy and early childhood last from birth until approximately three years of age. Children in these stages are very dependent on their parents to meet their needs. This is also when the bonds of attachment are created by meeting their babies' needs, developing trusting relationships, and promoting autonomy.

The priority for infants in the journey to attachment is having their basic needs met. Attentive and affectionate parents are able to develop trusting relationships with their infants. Engaging in regular physical contact, such as snuggling or baby wearing, increases both attachment and enjoyment between parent and child.

The following are ways that Campaigner parents can meet their infants' needs and create positive, trusting attachment.

Balanced Infant Bonding

Building Loving Bonds

From the moment their children are born, Campaigners throw all their energy into making sure their babies' needs are met, physically, spiritually, and emotionally. Building trusting, loving bonds with their infants comes naturally to individuals with this personality type. Infants need affection that goes beyond just daily care. Here are just some ways that loving Campaigner parents show their infants how much they love them:

- **Physical affection.** Campaigners provide affection by cuddling, rocking, and speaking softly to their infants.
- **Positive expressions.** Loving smiles and eye contact create primal connections that inspire the trust between parent and child.
- **Meeting their needs.** Campaigners channel their passion into dedication that ensures they will consistently meet their children's needs.

The infancy stage is a marathon, not a sprint. Working through the ups and downs of caring for babies dependent upon their parents is daunting. Campaigner parents' passion breeds the dedication needed to build bonds with their children during this overwhelming yet magical stage.

Open to Anything

While structure and schedules are important during the infancy stage, flexibility and the ability to quickly adapt to their changing needs are just as important. Midnight feedings, crying fits, and diaper disasters are just a few ways babies refuse to follow a schedule. Thankfully, Campaigners have some skills that make them particularly adept at handling these scenarios, including:

- Expecting the unexpected. Exceptional flexibility and an ability to thrive in unpredictable situations is a major Campaigner strength.
- Finding adjustments easy. Campaigners find it relatively easy to readjust their expectations when situations change.
- Open to new experiences. These types appreciate the new experiences this stage provides.
- Plenty of energy. Campaigner parents' excess energy allows them to keep up with their infants' often-changing needs.

Nothing bores these parents more than a strict, redundant schedule day in and day out. Fortunately, they won't have to worry about that with new babies. While not all interruptions to their schedules are pleasant, they're enough to keep Campaigner parents on their toes and prevent boredom.

If Campaigners fail to balance their own needs with the caretaking they provide, they will undoubtedly find themselves overwhelmed and exhausted. These parents are especially susceptible to being unrealistic about their expectations for both themselves and their children. This can manifest in the following ways.

Unbalanced Infant Bonding

Taking On Too Much

When Campaigner parents become too focused on living up to the unrealistic expectations placed by either themselves or others, they can find themselves taking on more than they can handle, such as:

- **Filling their plates.** Campaigners are prone to returning to a full plate of activities and obligations – just like they had before their children came into the picture.
- **Going too fast.** These parents may attempt to play the role of "super parents" by going back to work right away or obsessing about keeping up with an unrealistically busy social calendar.
- **Caving in.** Campaigners can fall prey to the pressure to be everything to everyone.

Being parents who can "do it all" may feel good, in the beginning. Ultimately, however, Campaigner parents will stress themselves out physically, mentally, spiritually, and emotionally. This stress can lead to significant negative consequences – like exhaustion, frustration, and anger – for both parents and babies.

From Daydreams to Diaper Detail

Many Campaigners have a very idealized vision of what it's like to parent infants. The late nights and piles of dirty diapers are a wake-up call that can be especially shocking to these dreamy Campaigners. This is especially true if they were unprepared for the enormity of the responsibility now before them. Specifically, they struggle with:

- **Focusing only on fun.** Visions of baby-and-me yoga classes and cooing over a smiling infant splashing in the tub will inevitably be doused by the reality of all-night crying sessions and mountains of dirty diapers.
- **Reality checks.** Campaigners' dreams of basking in the magical moments of infancy are certain to be met with the fact that they must meet their infants' practical and emotional needs.

Such levels of security and stability can seem like tricky concepts to any new parent. But inexperienced Campaigner parents can find this adjustment especially difficult.

Rebalancing Infant Bonding

Learning to Lighten the Load

The infant stage is short-lived, making this developmental window relatively small. Rather than trying to maintain a hectic lifestyle, Campaigner parents can use this stage to focus on attachment between themselves and their infants. This will help them to lay a strong foundation for their future relationships with their children.

It may be a challenge for Campaigners to switch modes from "always on the go" to prioritizing their parent-child relationship. However, it's important for them to remember that this dramatic change need not be permanent. Once they have built trust with their child, Campaigners can work to find a new balance between meeting personal needs and external obligations.

One method Campaigner parents can use to make sure that they're focusing on their present needs is to develop a "filtering system." This system can be used to sift out unnecessary activities to make time for what is important. This can be done as follows:

- On a piece of paper, or at the top of your calendar, write your number one priority.
- For each activity or event you have scheduled, ask yourself if that situation aligns with your number one priority.
- If it does, yet you still feel stressed at the idea of attending, determine if it can be rescheduled – and ask yourself, "What will I miss if I don't show up?"
- Remove any activity or event that doesn't align with your priority or that you are not comfortable with attending.
- Breathe a sigh of relief and let go of any guilt you may have for not having a packed schedule.

Example: You have decided that your number one priority is having quality time with your family each day. Looking over your schedule, you see there are several commitments on your calendar that will keep you away from your family for most of the day (an after-work meeting, a dinner party on your only day off, and so on).

Using your filtering system, you determine that you can't miss your work meeting, but you can take a raincheck for the dinner party on your next day off, so you do so. You reschedule a couple of coffee dates for the following month when you know things will be slower at work. Not only is your schedule lighter, but you also know that you'll have more quality time with your family – and some coffee dates – to look forward to.

Finding Beauty in the Midst of Frustration

It's easy to see the beauty in those moments where a baby is sleeping peacefully or cooing at their parent. However, beauty can seem absent in those moments where the baby won't stop crying, or when the laundry is piled up so high, it resembles a geological formation. Most people would advise Campaigners to just "deal with it," because parenthood is not always magical. These reality checks will only further frustrate Campaigner parents. A more effective approach to this problem is to purposely look for the beauty in unexpected places.

Wabi-sabi is a Japanese concept that can be summarized as "finding beauty in imperfection." Think of a handmade coffee mug, with its lack of symmetry and minor flaws. Part of the appeal of this item is that it is imperfect and has its own character and uniqueness. By adopting this approach, Campaigners can embrace these difficult moments and find the beauty within them.

These steps can help develop a meditation or gratitude practice when dealing with the less exciting parts of parenthood:

- Choose a mantra that promotes peace or gratitude.
- Repeat this mantra when doing any tasks that seem tedious or frustrating.
- Practice acknowledging your negative thoughts and countering them with a positive statement.

Example: You are rocking your baby back to sleep during the night... for the third time. Despite your frustration and exhaustion with this situation, you are determined to practice your mantra and to find the positive. You repeat the phrase, "I choose happiness," as you rock. When negative thoughts inevitably arise, you acknowledge them and respond to them with the statement, "I am grateful for this opportunity to spend this time with my child."

Testing Boundaries (From Approximately 1 ½ to 3 Years)

Once they're mobile, young children become very interested in exploring their environment with their senses. Crawling, walking, grabbing items, putting things in their mouths, and verbal communication are just a few ways that toddlers learn about the world around them.

During this stage, Campaigner parents must provide a safe base for their children while still allowing them to experience and explore their surroundings. Toddlers who can test boundaries while still receiving parental support and encouragement develop a sense of autonomy. Those who are made to feel guilty for their desire to test boundaries may suffer from feelings of low self-worth that lasts throughout their lives.

Balanced Toddler Bonding

Trustworthy and Compassionate

Campaigner parents' energy and compassion are especially useful during the trying toddler stage. These years can certainly be challenging. However, confident Campaigner parents take great joy in promoting their children's curiosity and independence while still maintaining a safe environment. Helping their kids learn to become creative, compassionate, and self-reliant is one of Campaigner parents' greatest joys. They are especially proficient at the following:

- **Providing stability.** Extremely supportive, Campaigners are a compassionate "home base" for their children during this stage.
- **Maintaining conviction.** Their engagement and determination to meet their toddlers' needs ensure that Campaigners' children never feel abandoned, ignored, or unloved.
- **Supporting growth.** They take pleasure in helping their little ones learn how to be self-reliant and eagerly support their children's natural creativity and self-expression.

Even though children at this age are incredibly independent, they still want trustworthy caregivers, and Campaigner parents don't disappoint.

Empathic Understanding

If Campaigners relate with greater ease than most to children – toddlers included – it's because they see the world through the same fresh eyes. They are especially adept at:

- **Keeping up.** Exuding playfulness and energy comes in handy when dealing with the boundless energy that accompanies children at this stage.
- **Seeing the best.** Campaigners appreciate how sincerely and authentically children interact with the world around them.
- **Meeting children at their level.** An ability to understand their toddlers' intentions is especially beneficial for Campaigner parents when dealing with less-than-desirable behaviors.

Toddlers have a natural desire to test boundaries, and this can be frustrating when parents take their seemingly negative behaviors personally. Campaigner parents, with their empathic understanding, can see the underlying reasons for angry outbursts and temper tantrums. Rather than yelling, Campaigners are much more likely to provide a loving explanation and a compassionate reaction. There's little room for shaming or guilt-inducing reactions when these parents can tap into their inherent empathy.

Unbalanced Toddler Bonding

Highly Reactive

Campaigners are a naturally emotional personality type. They feel every feeling deeply. When their emotions take charge, it can be difficult for Campaigner parents to bring them under control. This can cause the following issues:

- **Constantly overreacting.** Campaigner parents who fall victim to their fears ("Am I ruining my child? Is he/she hurt? Does this temper tantrum at the grocery store mean my child is going to become a psychopath?") can find themselves constantly overreacting.
- **Causing confusion.** When parenting toddlers (who are also known to let their emotions rule the show, but for very different reasons),

reactive or emotional responses can cause confusion and prevent healthy exploration.

- **Succumbing to fear.** Hovering parents who panic every time their children put rocks near their mouths or wave hello at strangers are more likely to instill fear than to provide protection.

Toddlers need a calm, intentional home base to develop independence. Fearful or reactive parents can create an unstable foundation for the exploration necessary to achieve this independence. Campaigner parents can disguise their less-than-effective behaviors as being engaged. But, if they fail to acknowledge the consequences of their reactivity, they can do both their children and themselves harm.

Too Permissive

Toddlers are professional boundary pushers, and Campaigners just want everyone to get along and have fun. Even the mere idea of their children's unhappiness can cause existential crises for overwhelmed Campaigner parents. This sensitivity can result in the following:

- **Giving up and giving in.** If their emotions run high, like when they're enduring constant battles and temper tantrums, Campaigners may cave into their toddlers' demands.
- **Failing to provide structure.** Less experienced parents of this personality type are prone to a lack of structure. This risks depriving their children of the consistency they need to thrive at this stage.
- **Promoting negative behaviors.** Overly permissive Campaigner parents will give in to their children's demands. In doing so, they are telling their toddlers that holding out long enough eventually gets them whatever they want.

Beyond giving in to their demands, permissive parents often fail to consistently enforce consequences for negative behavior. They may believe they're giving their children freedom and friendship rather than restrictive rules. However, Campaigner parents who fail to uphold necessary boundaries can set their children up for future problems. This can include behavioral issues, a lack of follow-through, and poor decision-making skills.

Rebalancing Toddler Bonding

Practice Loving Redirection

Pushing boundaries and defiant behavior are hallmarks of the toddler stage, and while they can be frustrating, they're a necessary part of developing independence. It's easy to respond irrationally in these trying circumstances. Impulsive reactions, however, are not only unproductive – they make the situation worse. Campaigners must take time to understand that their toddlers are becoming independent, not turning into pint-sized criminals. Once they change their mindset and embrace understanding instead of fear, these parents will have an easier time providing the guidance that their toddlers need.

Approaching the toddler stage as one of learning and exploration can help Campaigner parents put their needs into a more balanced perspective. It can also help to prevent negative responses. The following is an example of how to approach a potentially frustrating experience (leaving the park) in a proactive rather than a reactive way:

- When arriving at the park, Campaigner parents should let their toddlers know how long they will be there.
- Start the countdown at least 15 minutes before leaving.
- Walk calmly toward the toddlers when there's about one minute left.

Example: You arrive at the park with your toddler and let her know that you will be there for 30 minutes and then you will go home for lunch. When there are 15 minutes left before you will leave, you announce the time left in five-minute increments. ("We are leaving in 15 minutes." "Ten minutes left before we leave." "Ok, five minutes left.") Engaging in eye contact, you calmly walk toward your child and help her go down the slide one last time. ("Okay, kiddo, one more time down the slide! Go, go! Yay!")

This process allows children to complete any activities they want and ensures that they understand their parents' expectations. It also provides Campaigners with a way to prevent temper tantrums before they happen, rather than reacting to these outbursts emotionally.

Being Supportive with Structure and Discipline

There's nothing wrong with Campaigners wanting their children to like them, or in promoting freedom and independence from a young age. When harmony and independence take priority over their children's need for structure and discipline, however, it can cause problems for the whole family. Toddlers are incapable of fully understanding the consequences of their behavior. This is especially true when their parents fail to explain or enforce household rules. Thankfully, it's possible for these types to maintain loving bonds with their children while still providing boundaries.

The following is an accountability plan that Campaigner parents can take to create to set their children (and themselves) up for the most successful future possible:

- Make sure household expectations and rules are well known to all members of the family – including specific, age-appropriate rules and tasks for your toddler.
- Be consistent in enforcing rules, and make sure that children know the consequences of breaking them.
- Reward positive behaviors with special privileges or treats.
- Don't give up – enlist a spouse, partner, family member, or close friend to be an "accountability partner" and to assist when situations become overwhelming.

Example: Your family worked together, using input from everyone to make a list of rules that promote respect, love, and safety. Your toddler was involved in this process, and practices reciting the family motto, "Love and respect everyone and everything," each day.

When the rules are broken, you remind your toddler of the motto and ask if those actions were loving or respectful. ("Was it loving or respectful to take the book from your brother?) Consequences are enforced ("You'll have to sit in the quiet chair for a few minutes until you can be nicer") when the behavior does not stop.

Later in the day, your toddler offers to share his toy car with his brother, prompting you to "reward" him by saying, "Way to share with your brother! That was very loving."

Children who are aware of what is expected from them at a young age are less likely to struggle with temper tantrums than children who receive inconsistent discipline. Making an effort to set up clear, consistent guidelines with them up front can pay off exponentially in the long run.

Thirst for Knowledge (From Approximately 3 to 5 Years)

The preschool years, from approximately three to five years of age, are a prime time for brain development. Kids absorb information like sponges during this stage through constant activity and endless questions. Learning at this stage takes place through play, especially the unstructured kind, and lots of social interaction with family and peers. Creativity is also exercised through imaginary play and make-believe games and stories.

To master this stage, children must be given the opportunity to not only make some of their own decisions but also be allowed to initiate activities. They should be encouraged to ask questions – and receive answers – and lead others in play. Those who aren't given these opportunities, or are made to feel as though they are annoying, can experience feelings of guilt and frustration. Consequently, they may suffer from poor self-control or a lack of initiative.

Balanced Preschool Relationships

Natural Teachers

As lifelong learners themselves, Campaigner parents tend to look forward to inspiring their children to enjoy learning. They happily answer their preschoolers' constant streams of questions. These parents take great pleasure in finding creative ways to engage their children in learning opportunities. Promoting learning takes place in these ways for Campaigner parents:

- **Informal lessons.** From trips to the library to impromptu nature "classes" while walking in the park, these parents tend to take any chance they can to engage with and inspire their preschoolers.

- **Modeling morals.** Seeking educational opportunities isn't the only form of teaching that Campaigners engage in. These parents also model morals and values for their children from a young age.
- **Promoting positive traits.** These parents teach their children to not only respect others but also appreciate their differences.

Compassion is a defining characteristic of Campaigners, and they go out of their way to model this behavior for their kids. These parents would pull their cars over to help a wounded animal, even while running late to school. Preschoolers can not only witness their parents' actions but can also learn to help in age-appropriate ways.

Emotionally Engaged

Life with their preschoolers isn't only about learning or "teachable moments." Self-control, empathy, and relationships (especially with peers) are all beginning to develop. Children at this stage need guidance to develop these skills properly. Emotional engagement is one of Campaigners' greatest strengths. It is one of their number one priorities as parents, both in terms of building bonds with their children and in teaching them how to develop their emotional intelligence.

These skills are best learned through modeling, and this is where Campaigner parents can truly shine. They model these desired behaviors in the following ways:

- Engaging with others quickly and authentically.
- Expressing love and compassion for others.
- Using imaginary play as an outlet for practicing these skills.

Something as simple as playing a game of "house" with their children can be a perfect opportunity for these parents to model healthy relationships. They can also practice lovingly redirecting less-than-desirable behaviors. This allows Campaigners to pass on their emotional wisdom and improve their parent-child bonds as well.

Unbalanced Preschool Relationships

Exceedingly Ambitious

The preschool years bring a new level of energy as children become more interested in making sense of the world around them. Kids at this stage are more mobile and opinionated than ever. This can try the patience of even the most devoted parents. Parenting is an exhausting endeavor for even the most energetic individuals. Campaigners rarely struggle to maintain the energy necessary to keep up with their children. However, they tend to overestimate how much they can, and should, do in addition to caring for their preschoolers. Consider these issues they may face:

- **Trying to do everything.** Campaigner parents who fall into the trap of busyness are especially likely to become overworked and overwhelmed during this stage. Just keeping up with housework, jobs, and the multiple needs of everyone in the household can be exhausting.
- **Always taking on extra.** Life for Campaigners becomes even more challenging at this stage when they also feel the need to run their children from preschool to play dates to swimming lessons and karate classes.
- **Feeling obligated to impress.** Parents today may also feel burdened by the need to make every birthday party and family vacation worthy of posting on social media.

Perfect parenting in the digital age can quickly take a toll on Campaigners. These parents would much prefer to focus on the meaningful aspects of life over the marketable content. Joining every club and class available and keeping a busy social calendar for kids and parents may sound exciting and invigorating. Campaigner parents who take on too much, however, may find these enrichment opportunities to be a drain on true quality time with their preschoolers.

Struggling with Schedules

The same issues that can lead to stress for Campaigner parents are often the root cause of the schedule anxiety that they're apt to succumb to during this stage. The preschool years often bring with

them an exponential increase in activities and external expectations. Preschool classes, playdates, and birthday parties suddenly flood their children's schedules. Parents are naturally expected to be involved in these outside activities with their kids. For Campaigners, who despise schedules and struggle with making plans and being on time, this stage can test their limits.

As Prospecting types, Campaigners prefer freedom over itineraries. This laid-back mentality can spiral into irresponsible behaviors and frustration, especially for less mature Campaigners, such as:

- **Tardiness.** Distracted Campaigner parents may always arrive late when bringing the kids to classes or play dates.
- **Constant stress.** Burdened Campaigners will experience constant stress when they are frequently running behind schedule, forgetting appointments, and always trying to squeeze in "one more errand."
- **Refusing to adjust.** Campaigner parents who believe that frequent unreliability is a sustainable way to operate are inevitably setting themselves and their children up for a frantic and stressful lifestyle.

Campaigner parents who fail to effectively organize their lives will live in a state of constant chaos.

Rebalancing Preschool Relationships

Adjusting Expectations

Rather than letting their ambition drive them to the brink of burnout, Campaigner parents must learn to say "no." This includes saying no to endless play dates and nature classes and saying "yes" to taking much-needed breaks. Children benefit more from healthy, happy parents than Internet-inspired birthday parties, pony rides, or goody bags worthy of the Oscars.

One activity Campaigner parents can do if they are looking to bring balance into this busy stage is to develop a "priority plan." This plan will help them to determine how to prioritize quality and quantity time as a family. This can be done in the following way:

- Grab your calendar and make a list of the extracurricular activities both you and your children have planned for the next two weeks.
- Next to each activity, write down approximately how much time it will take – include commute time to and from the activity.
- Calculate how many hours you will be spending on non-necessary activities for those two weeks.
- Consider removing two activities per week and, instead, schedule in time to spend with your child with no agenda or expectations.
- Once you have enjoyed this scheduled quality time with your child, go through the next two weeks on your calendar and repeat this process.

Example: Looking over your schedule, you see you have six activities one week and four the next week that aren't "required." When calculating how long they will take, you realize you will be spending over 20 hours commuting and attending non-necessary activities in the next two weeks! You remove four activities total and schedule in quality family time instead.

Over those two weeks, you and your child have quality time together at home. You also go to the park and take a trip to the zoo. The time you spent together has been so enjoyable and meaningful that you block out time in your "priority plan" each week for these "quality time" dates with your child.

Campaigner parents may initially feel some guilt for not living up to societal expectations – or even their own perfectionism. These parents can ultimately feel liberated, however, when they reduce unnecessary obligations. Their natural tendency is to live their lives based on their values, not society's expectations. Campaigner parents must find their way back to what is important to them and how they want to raise their children. Doing the above exercise can help these parents keep their values and their family firmly at the top of their priority list.

Creating Sanity out of Chaos

There's nothing like parenthood to make Campaigners aware of some of their own flaws. Scheduling, organization, and details, in general, can elude many parents with this personality type. It's important for their sanity (and the sanity of those around them) to figure out how to deal

with these issues once children enter the picture. Words like "structure" and "planning" can sound like torture to those who thrive on flexibility. However, Campaigners will find that building a daily rhythm into their lives actually provides them with more freedom.

Many Campaigners, especially those who are parents, fail to take the time they need to recharge their own batteries. Even with their boundless energy, these types can easily become overwhelmed, especially when shuttling ever-more-energetic preschoolers around all day. A daily rhythm can provide the structure necessary to meet everyone's needs and accomplish tasks. It can also create a sense of control, providing Campaigner parents with a reprieve from feelings of chaos that are a source of stress and distraction.

These tips can help Campaigners create a daily rhythm that helps them to find sanity in the bedlam of parenthood:

- First, and most important, determine daily priorities that must be accommodated every day – such as alone time, family time, exercise, or time for engaging in hobbies.
- Utilize scheduling tools to help organize these priorities – an online calendar, a bullet journal, a day planner, or even a large family calendar hanging in the kitchen or family room.
- When creating a schedule for the day, include periods of time with nothing scheduled – this allows for flexibility.
- Figure out a schedule or rhythm that works best for the family, and commit to following that rhythm for at least 28 days, so it evolves into a habit.

Going through this process regularly will encourage Campaigner parents to keep a less hectic schedule and still have the flexibility they crave. Preschoolers also benefit from this rhythm. This approach provides them with the stability they need to make them feel safe and grounded.

Creating Competence (From Approximately 5 to 12 Years)

The early school years are an important period of skill development for young children. Not only are they still absorbing new information, but they're also working on becoming capable in increasingly complex areas. Children who are both challenged and supported in these areas flourish in both their abilities and their self-confidence.

If they don't receive consistent support, kids at this stage can feel inferior to their peers. They are also less likely to develop long-term goals or work toward achieving them. If they aren't sufficiently challenged, children in this stage can feel overly confident in themselves and their abilities. Those who are treated as "overly precious" may lack humility and compassion toward others. These children can struggle coping with the inevitable failures they will face throughout their lives.

Balanced School-Age Relationships

Passionate and Encouraging

Encouragement, one of Campaigner parents' greatest strengths, extends beyond just academics. They also focus on supporting their children's social and personal development. Their empathic nature helps these types to quickly realize when their children may be struggling. This allows them to step in and offer their support before the situation gets too serious. These parents work to provide their children with tools to help them deal with the potential challenges they will face. Specifically, they encourage determination and creative problem-solving skills to help their children deal with difficult peers or frustrating fights with friends.

On the academic side, Campaigner parents are likely to:

- **Encourage curiosity.** Campaigners are passionate about encouraging their children to pursue their education with energy and curiosity.
- **Promote positive values.** These parents also emphasize that passing spelling tests and memorizing multiplication tables aren't any less important than traits like creativity and compassion.

- **Seek opportunities.** Campaigner parents will explore alternative options to help their children achieve their full potential if they feel they aren't receiving a holistic education.

A zest for both life and learning helps Campaigner parents of school-aged children to provide support and encouragement when needed most.

Humanistic Mentors

The school-age years are a time of intense learning, not just academically but emotionally, spiritually, and socially. Mature Campaigners model the skills needed to be compassionate, considerate, and motivated individuals. Yes, children need to learn mathematics and writing. However, if their education fails to incorporate human elements like spiritual and emotional needs, they can ultimately end up confused and unfulfilled. Campaigners tend to go out of their way to ensure that their kids find meaning in everything they do by:

- **Encouraging individuality.** Campaigners encourage their children to incorporate their unique ideas and perspectives into both their academic and personal lives.
- **Inspiring integration.** These types inspire their school-aged kids to integrate their passions and causes into all areas – from science projects focused on solving global warming issues, to participating in community volunteer days.
- **Emboldening innovation.** Campaigner parents want their children to pursue passions that focus on innovation and creativity over the rote memorization that's often expected at this stage.

At this stage, children are constantly being told what to do and are conforming to many strict schedules. In light of this, Campaigner parents typically work hard to ensure that innovation and creativity can still flourish.

Unbalanced School-Age Relationships

Unorganized and Unfocused

The school years lay the foundation for developing both competence and personal responsibility. Teachers and classmates may have a significant amount of interaction and influence on children during the school day, but if these skills aren't modeled in the home as well, they won't stick. Some of the more negative traits they may model include being:

- **Unfocused.** Campaigner parents who have yet to master their own "study skills" are likely to have trouble helping their sons and daughters develop theirs.
- **Unstructured.** These parents' amiable, go-with-the-flow nature runs counter to the structure and responsibility needed to succeed in an educational setting.
- **Disorganized.** Campaigner parents who are continuously running late, are always trying to squeeze in an additional errand, and never seem to know how much money is in the checking account are only modeling disorganization and chaos.

Campaigner parents may throw the best birthday parties. However, when it comes to helping their children sit down and work on long, complicated lessons, these parents are prone to distraction.

Unrealistic Idealism

Campaigners' big-picture mentality can cause issues for their children at this stage if it isn't properly balanced with their kids' needs and abilities. School-aged children benefit from being concerned about protecting the environment and practicing compassion toward all living things. However, they also need parents who can help them address some of the daily practical issues they may face. From a school crush that isn't reciprocated to the trauma of a friend's betrayal – children at this age need parents who can help them deal with personal issues. If they are not willing or able to, it may result in:

- **Only seeing the big picture.** Campaigner parents who constantly focus on the bigger picture can fail to validate their children's feelings on "smaller" issues, and their children can become less likely to seek their help or support.

- **Poor coping skills.** They're also failing to teach children to cope with inevitable defeats or struggles by avoiding them and directing their attention to something else instead.

Sure, the world will not end if their children don't make the basketball team, but that can feel catastrophic to kids at this stage. To them, everything that happens to them is a big deal. Campaigner parents who don't recognize this, and don't help their children put things into perspective in a realistic way, can struggle to maintain a close relationship with them.

Rebalancing School-Age Relationships

Finding Focus

Campaigners have difficulties with organization and structure due to a lack of focus, mostly because they're busy All. Of. The. Time. It's difficult to focus on any one thing when their attention is being pulled in a multitude of directions (which is basically the definition of parenthood). All hope isn't lost, however, because even the most distracted Campaigners can improve their focus. And when they are focused, they can help their children to develop the skills necessary to be organized and productive individuals.

Many techniques can improve focus, but it's often the simple ones that are the most effective. Specifically, a regular mindful breathing practice can help Campaigners achieve a calm, centered state of mind. Practicing this skill not only improves their ability to assist their children with school work, but they also model the skills that their children need to be successful in school and life.

The following breathing exercise can help Campaigners and their children (it's never too early to start!) to improve their mental focus:

- Begin by focusing on breathing – slow, deep breaths.
- Notice when thoughts start to creep up.
- Acknowledge each though, without dwelling, and simply let it go.
- Return focus to the breath, focusing on each inhale and exhale.

- Repeat twice per day or whenever the mind is feeling especially distracted.

Focus is a valuable skill, especially with the incessant distractions posed by today's pocket-sized technologies. Meeting goals and self-improvement require focus, whether it's concentrating while studying for an exam or avoiding distractions while finishing a presentation for work. Proficiency in anything during any stage of life takes concentration. Campaigner parents who help their children develop this skill during this stage can set them up for successful and productive futures.

Meeting Children Where They Are

Attentive and compassionate, Campaigners excel at supporting their children and providing them with copious amounts of affection. When they become too caught up in the big picture, however, these parents may ignore the details of their children's experiences. Kids at this stage want to be heard and understood and to have their experiences validated. Campaigners are more than capable of providing the unconditional love and acceptance their children need and can use these skills to home in on what they need to feel understood.

Campaigners prone to fixating on the "big picture" can benefit from focusing on what their children are dealing with right now. This exercise can help Campaigner parents to engage with their children in the "here and now" and address some of the more difficult aspects of life:

- Schedule a parent-child date once every week to spend time listening to their struggles and successes without trying to redirect them to consider a more positive potential.
- Listen, make eye contact, and express interest whenever your children are speaking to you – no daydreaming or staring at a screen.
- Acknowledge their frustrations, fears, or disappointments by using phrasing such as, "I really see how frustrated you get when…" or, "I understand your fear of…"

Example: You've noticed that your child has been quieter than usual. He hasn't been chatting with you about his day after he gets home from

school like he used to. Admittedly, you've been busy with a work deadline and haven't been as attentive as usual. You schedule a parent-child date. You go to his favorite diner for French fries and burgers and ask a few lighthearted questions about school, skateboarding, and video games. Without additional prompting, he opens up about a fight he had with his friend that's been bothering him. Instead of immediately giving advice, you listen carefully and are impressed as he works out a solution to the issue on his own.

Sometimes the situations suck, so let kids acknowledge that they suck without trying to sugarcoat them. Support doesn't always have to look like rainbows and sunshine – sometimes it is more meaningful to lend a listening ear and acknowledge how crappy the situation is. Children at this stage will appreciate the sincerity and attention much more than unbridled and unrealistic idealism.

Find Thyself (From Approximately 12 to 18 Years)

Adolescence is the transition from childhood to adulthood, where teens focus on developing their own distinct sense of identity. This period centers around their sense of what their roles are in their relationships with themselves, others, and society in general. To determine their roles, children in this stage begin the all-important process of identifying their personal values and beliefs. Future educational and career goals are made, and relationships are developed based on how they align with these values and beliefs. These processes make this a pivotal, foundational stage for the rest of their lives.

Balanced Adolescent Relationships

Promoting Positive Values

During this stage of identity development, adolescents need the support and understanding of their parents more than ever. Campaigners understand the importance of encouraging their children in their personal development without attempting to take over this process for them. They model this support and personal growth in these ways:

- **Promoting positive values.** Campaigner parents encourage their adolescent children's growth by promoting such positive values as responsibility, compassion, and honesty.
- **Providing freedom.** They provide their adolescents with the freedom to explore their chosen values in their own unique ways.
- **Being reliable resources.** Campaigners remain steadfast in their devotion to their children regardless of the struggles that they may face during this tumultuous time.

Their dedication to the promotion of their positive values and their compassion provide a solid foundation for both themselves and their adolescents. This foundation allows identity-seeking children to seek self-discovery while still feeling a sense of support and love.

Authentic and Committed

Adolescence can be a stormy stage for most children, as they attempt to determine who they are and who they want to be. These discoveries are often made through trial and error, so many mistakes are made. Honesty is necessary to help children learn from their mistakes – adolescents who skip class needs to know the potential consequences of this behavior before it's too late. As parents, Campaigners can be:

- **Extraordinarily authentic.** Campaigner parents' honesty and unwavering commitment are indispensable during this stage.
- **Steadfast in their commitment.** These types can provide their teenagers with the confidence to communicate with them, even when the topics are uncomfortable.
- **Understanding and nonjudgmental.** As parents, Campaigners can withhold judgment and criticism even in the midst of difficult situations.

If these parents can maintain their authentic communication, they will establish themselves as sources of stability and wisdom when their children need them most. Perhaps more important, Campaigner parents who embody these traits are more likely to have children competent in these areas. Authentic communication and commitment amid difficulties may not be skills an employer asks for. However, they

are some of the most meaningful and useful skills adolescents can learn for their future relationships.

Unbalanced Adolescent Relationships

Failing to Create Boundaries

The process of self-discovery is a favorite topic for many Campaigners, who gladly pass their passion for growth on to their adolescent children. This is all fine and good, until they prioritize the promotion of independence over establishing or enforcing healthy boundaries for their teens. Overly permissive Campaigner parents may struggle with:

- **Being overly permissive.** Campaigners may fall into the trap of permitting inappropriate behavior for the sake of allowing their children to "find themselves" – which isn't only unwise, it's downright dangerous.
- **Failing to create boundaries.** These parents may struggle with setting and enforcing boundaries because they're afraid of infringing on their children's autonomy.
- **Providing too much independence.** Campaigners may forgo curfews for their teenagers because they want to respect their independence. This may unintentionally encourage nefarious activities such as drinking, doing drugs, participating in vandalism, or having sex.

Even the most mature adolescents will make poor choices if they're consistently exposed to tempting situations. Further, teenagers never given proper boundaries or consistent expectations can lack the skills to create such boundaries for themselves.

Difficulty Detaching

The adolescent stage requires that children become more independent from their parents. They begin making critical life choices on their own and relying less on Mom or Dad for support. As their children strike out on their own, Campaigner parents may mourn the end of childhood, remembering that sweet kindergartener they walked into class on the first day of school. This fear and sadness can manifest in several other ways, such as:

- **Feeling rejected.** Campaigner parents can struggle with feelings of rejection if they believe their kids no longer need them or desire their affection.
- **Struggling to redefine their purpose.** For some Campaigners, parenthood is their "purpose," and being parents is the most important part of their identities.
- **Losing their identities.** If they fail to maintain or nurture other parts of their identities, these parents may fail to evolve in their roles as primary caregivers.

During this stage, Campaigner parents may feel lost and lonely if they have failed to maintain friendships or pursue meaningful work or hobbies. As their children inevitably spend more time away from home, they may experience a deep sense of loss, and even uncertainty of their own futures.

Rebalancing Adolescent Relationships

Creating Responsible Boundaries

Boundaries are necessary for children of all ages to gain skills and confidence in a safe and understanding environment. Campaigner parents aren't doing their adolescent children any favors by allowing them to explore the world without guidelines or discipline. The dangers of this permissive approach are much more prominent than any potential benefits. While enforcing rules and restricting behaviors goes against their live-and-let-live nature, it's important that they learn to appreciate and value these skills for the safety and security they provide.

At this stage, the adolescent brain – specifically the prefrontal cortex, which is responsible for future planning – isn't fully developed. As a result, teens often don't realize the potential consequences of their actions. Fortunately, parents are there to fill the role of planner for their teenagers. Campaigner parents create necessary boundaries for their children, from curfews to consequences for inappropriate behaviors.

Teens who are failing one of their classes may need to be restricted from certain activities or screen time until their behavior or grades improve. Likewise, adolescents spending time with troublesome peers may need strictly enforced curfews. Campaigners may chafe at these restrictions. Ultimately, parents are responsible for providing the structure and security their adolescent children struggle to provide for themselves.

The following "four Cs" exercise can help Campaigner parents enforce effective boundaries with their children:

- Foremost, make sure that boundaries and expectations are **Clear** – there's much less confusion or room for interpretation when they're spoken about frequently, or even written down somewhere prominent.
- Be **Consistent**. Address all issues immediately and, for the love of all things holy, follow through with any consequences previously threatened.
- Try to use **Creative** solutions for punishment beyond just grounding or taking away privileges. Consider having teens write a one-page report about upholding their commitments, or participating in a "community service" project like raking leaves or helping to clean out the garage.
- Stay **Calm** – or at least as calm as possible. Reacting to negative behaviors when feelings are raw is more likely to escalate the situation than improve it. Take a few minutes to engage in deep breathing or punch a pillow, whatever is necessary to diffuse angry emotions before discussing punishments.

Learning to Let Go

Learning to let go as their children grow and mature doesn't mean that Campaigners are no longer being loving, involved parents. Rather, it means reevaluating and readjusting what those parental roles are for this stage of life. Instead of feeling rejected when their children exert their newfound independence, Campaigner parents can learn to celebrate the progress and new milestones that their adolescents have achieved.

The "parent-as-primary-identity" stance can be especially strong for individuals with this personality type. This makes the "letting go" process trickier to navigate. Not only are their children attempting to develop their own personal identity, but Campaigner parents are redefining what their new identities will look like.

Maintaining a strong bond without being overly involved in their teens' growth requires walking a fine line. Campaigners who work toward achieving this balance can find this stage richly rewarding. As with other stages, modeling is often the best form of "teaching" their children. This approach will help both form (or re-form) their unique identities.

The following practice can help Campaigner parents to model personal growth techniques for their adolescent children in healthy, independent ways and determine their own needs during this transitional time:

- Start by doing a written self-reflection activity where you identify what activities you would like to do to better understand who you are and who you want to become.
- Consider discovering (or rediscovering) a spiritual or meditative practice that encourages finding meaning or purpose.
- Next, brainstorm hobbies that align with your values and purpose.
- Finally, schedule a 30-minute blog each day to incorporate these new practices or hobbies into your daily routine.

Example: Since your daughter has started driving herself to and from school and her extracurricular activities, you have found yourself with some free time during the week. Instead of working longer hours, however, you have taken some time to figure out what kind of meaningful activities you can engage in to enrich your life.

As you consider your values you realize that while you value creativity, you haven't been spending any time in creative pursuits. Remembering how much you loved taking pictures when you were younger, you sign up for a free online photography course. You block off some time that week to go take pictures near your favorite nature preserve.

Conclusion

Campaigners have their own unique strengths as parents – enthusiasm, friendliness, and curiosity. They can use these strengths to leverage any weaknesses and build positive, proactive relationships with their children. Parenthood provides many opportunities for personal development. Campaigners can gain a much deeper understanding of themselves and others if they use this opportunity to do so.

Remember that the advice provided above is based on general growth stages for children, and basic strengths and weaknesses that many Campaigners share. All children are different, and parents are the best judges of what their children need. The advice above should be used so it works best for each family without adding additional stress, frustration, or burden. For special situations, such as behavioral or medical issues, it's best to consult with a professional pediatrician or pediatric psychologist to come up with a plan that works best for everyone involved.

Final Words

Love with Emotional Wisdom

Having strong emotional intelligence helps Campaigners get – and provide – the most that they possibly can in personal relationships of all kinds. Their effusive, enthusiastic style makes their positive intentions clear, and their flexible receptiveness paves the way for others to be open with their thoughts and feelings. Wanting to establish an easy, unfettered emotional flow is a hallmark of the Campaigner personality type. However, robust emotional intelligence comes with some responsibility, because not everyone is as comfortable being so open with others, or having others open up to them, as Campaigners are.

One could say that emotional wisdom is knowing how to use emotional intelligence to approach very different kinds of people. At their best, Campaigners avoid being invasive or overwhelming by tempering their bright, outgoing energy somewhat to match the needs and limits of others. And it's not always about other people's different personalities – sometimes it's just about context and timing. There are moments when delicacy and reserve allow Campaigners to support or connect with other people better than forward, enveloping warmth would. Their instinct is to go all out with their love, and there's nothing wrong with seeking to bond with others on a deep level. Some situations and people simply call for more nuanced expressions of the love, affection, and positivity that can burn so brightly in Campaigners' hearts.

As Campaigners grow and mature, they tend to discover that forging the best relationships hinges not just on having positive intentions but also on using their emotional intelligence to understand what others want and accept. That may sometimes mean respecting boundaries that Campaigners themselves see little need for, just because it's important to someone else. But that's a sacrifice that Campaigners are usually willing to make, especially because showing that kind of care for people ultimately creates a deeper connection with them. Not everyone shows love in the vibrant Campaigner style, but that doesn't mean that it's not possible for Campaigners to have amazing relationships with all kinds of people, while still being themselves. When their wisdom and awareness match the enthusiasm in their hearts, they are truly capable of connection on a level that satisfies their deepest desires.

As friends, romantic partners, and parents, Campaigners crave connection not only for their own emotional fulfillment but also because they take such great joy in being part of the emotional fulfillment of others. Thanks to their personality traits, the fact that deep emotional connections occasionally require wise adaptation doesn't stand in the way of Campaigners' relationship goals. If anything, it brings them closer.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you better understand and strengthen your relationships? Explore our Relationships Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your academic or professional life? Check out the *Campaigner Guide to Careers*.
- Ready to build a strong foundation for your self-development? Our *Campaigner Guide to Personal Growth* may be just what you need.

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